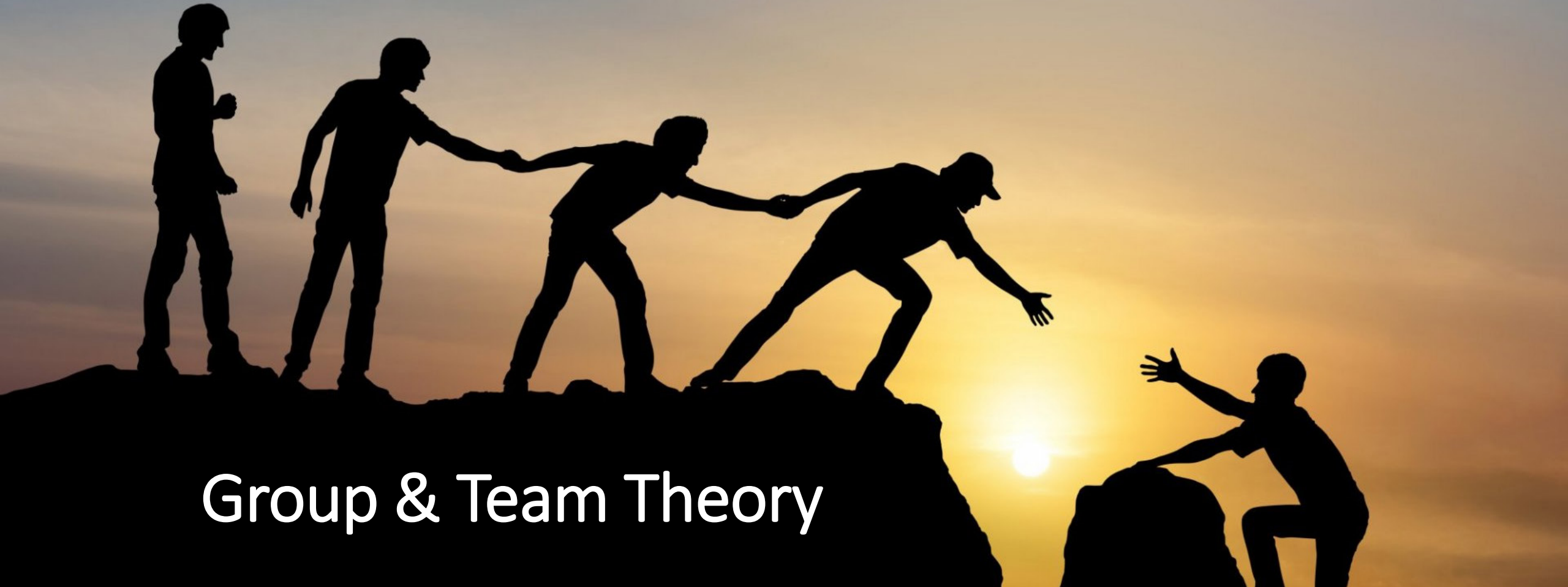




Session III

Group & Team Theory



Group & Team Theory

1. Power in Teams and Groups



Learning Objectives

- Explain different conceptualizations of power
- Discuss behaviors associated with high status in a group
- Differentiate between the common power bases in groups
- What is the nature of leadership and the leadership process



Learning Objectives

- How do leaders influence and move their followers to action?
- What are the trait perspectives on leadership?
- How do different approaches and styles of leadership impact what is needed now?



Power in Teams and Groups



Defining Power

“Power lives in
relationships,
not in people”

Power-Over

Power-from-Within

Power-With

Defining Power

“Power lives in relationships, not in people”

Power-Over

If you associate **power** with control or dominance, this refers to the notion of power as **power-over**.

According to Starhawk (1987), “*power-over enables one individual or group to make the decisions that affect others, and to enforce control*” (p. 9).

Defining Power

“Power lives in
relationships,
not in people”

Power-from-Within

Power-from-within refers to a more personal sense of strength or agency. Power-from-within manifests *itself when we can stand, walk, and speak “words that convey our needs and thoughts”* (Starhawk, 1987, p. 10).

In groups, this type of power “arises from our sense of connection, our bonding with other human beings, and with the environment” (10).

Defining Power

“Power lives in relationships, not in people”

Power-With

“The power of a strong individual in a group of equals, the power not to command, but to suggest and be listened to, to begin something and see it happen” (Starhawk, 1987, p. 10).

For this to be effective in a group or team, at least two qualities must be present among members: (1) all group members must communicate respect and equality for one another, and (2) the leader must not abuse power-with and attempt to turn it into power-over.

UNDERSTANDING POWER AND OPPRESSION

*Power and oppression can
be said to be mirror
reflections of one another
in a sense or two sides of
the same coin.*



STATUS

Can be defined as a person's perceived level of importance or significance within a particular context.

POWER

Members with higher status are apt to command greater respect and possess more prestige and power than those with lower status.



Relationship between Power and Status

BASES OF POWER IN GROUPS

Referent Power

Expert Power

Legitimate Power

Coercive Power

Reward Power

Bases of Power in Groups

Referent Power - Person B looks up to or admires person A, and, as a result, B follows A largely because of A's personal qualities, characteristics, or reputation. Person A can use **referent power** to influence B.

Referent power has also been called charismatic power, because allegiance is based on interpersonal attraction of one individual for another.

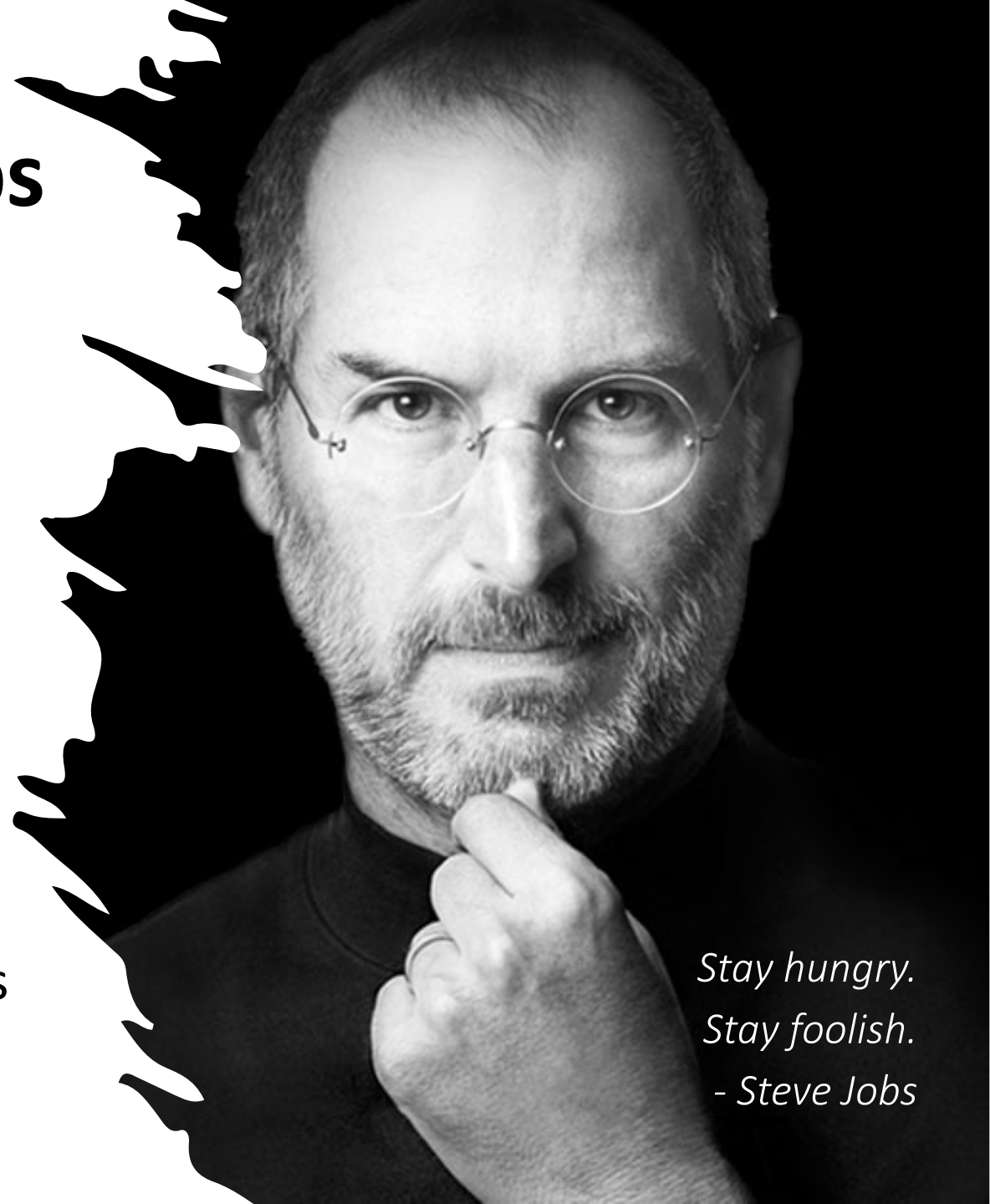


Bases of Power in Groups

Expert power is demonstrated when person *A* gains power because *A* has knowledge or expertise relevant to *B*.

For instance, professors presumably have power in the classroom because of their mastery of a particular subject matter.

In each case, the individual has credibility in a particular-and narrow-area as a result of experience and expertise, and this gives the individual power in that domain.



*Stay hungry.
Stay foolish.
- Steve Jobs*

Bases of Power in Groups

Legitimate power exists when person *B* submits to person *A* because *B* feels that *A* has a right to exert power in a certain domain (Tjosvold, 1985). Legitimate power is really another name for authority.

Legitimate power differs from reward and coercive power in that it depends on the official position a person holds, and not on his or her relationship with others.



Bases of Power in Groups

Coercive power is based primarily on fear. Here, person *A* has power over person *B* because *A* can administer some form of punishment to *B*. Thus, this kind of power is also referred to as punishment power.

Coercive power does not have to rest on the threat of violence. “Individuals exercise coercive power through a reliance upon physical strength, verbal facility, or the ability to grant or withhold emotional support from others. These bases provide the individual with the means to physically harm, bully, humiliate, or deny love to others” (Kipnis, 1976).



Bases of Power in Groups

Reward power exists when person A has power over person B because A controls rewards that B wants.

Research has indicated that reward power often leads to increased job performance as employees see a strong performance-reward contingency (Shetty, 1978).



Consequences of Power

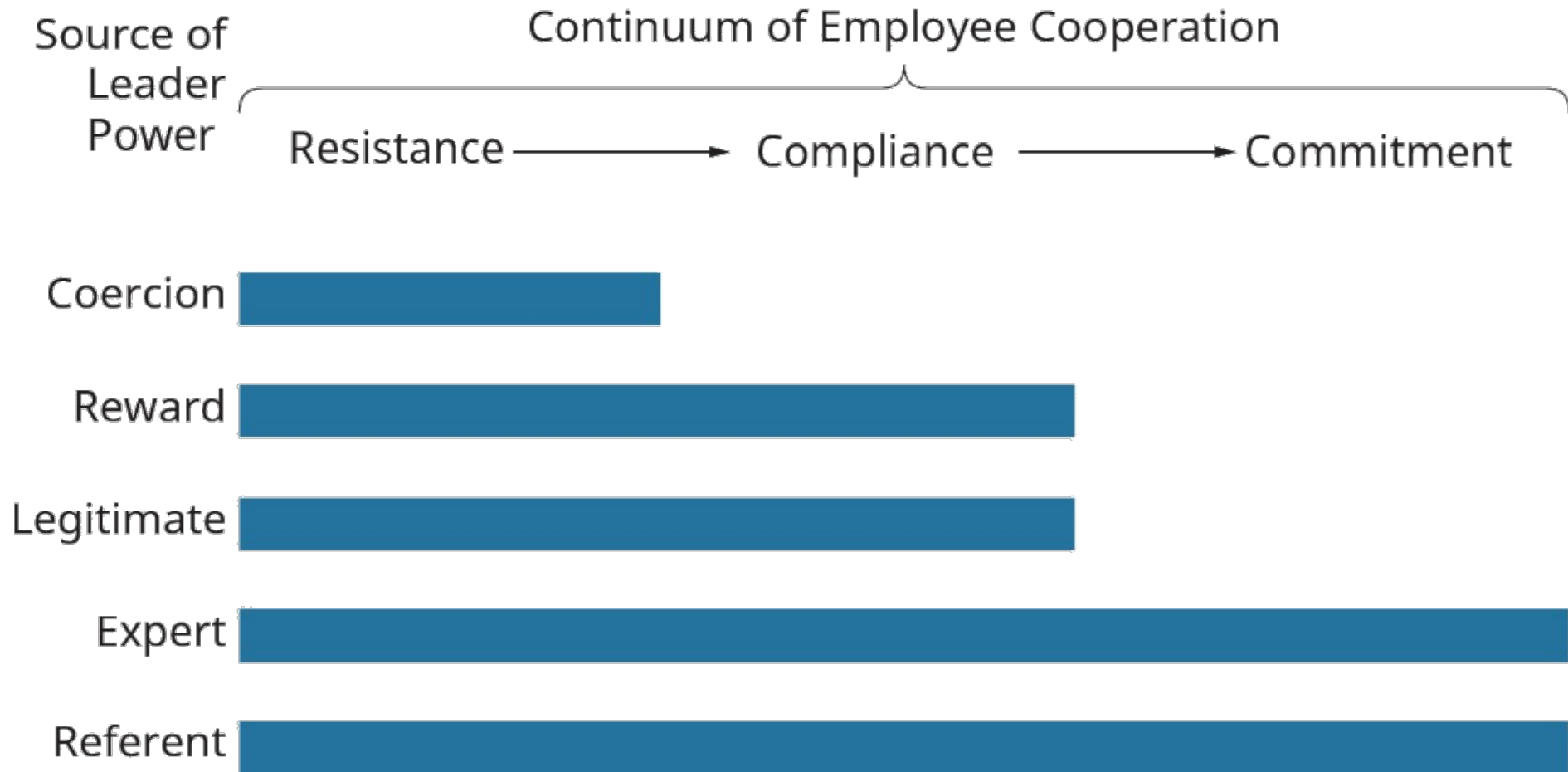


Figure 1 (Credit: Rice University Openstax/Employee Reactions to Bases of Power/CC BY-NC-SA 4.0.

Power Dependencies

- In any situation involving power, at least two persons (or groups) can be identified:
 1. The person attempting to influence others and
 2. The target or targets of that influence.
- All people are not subject to (or dependent upon) the same bases of power.





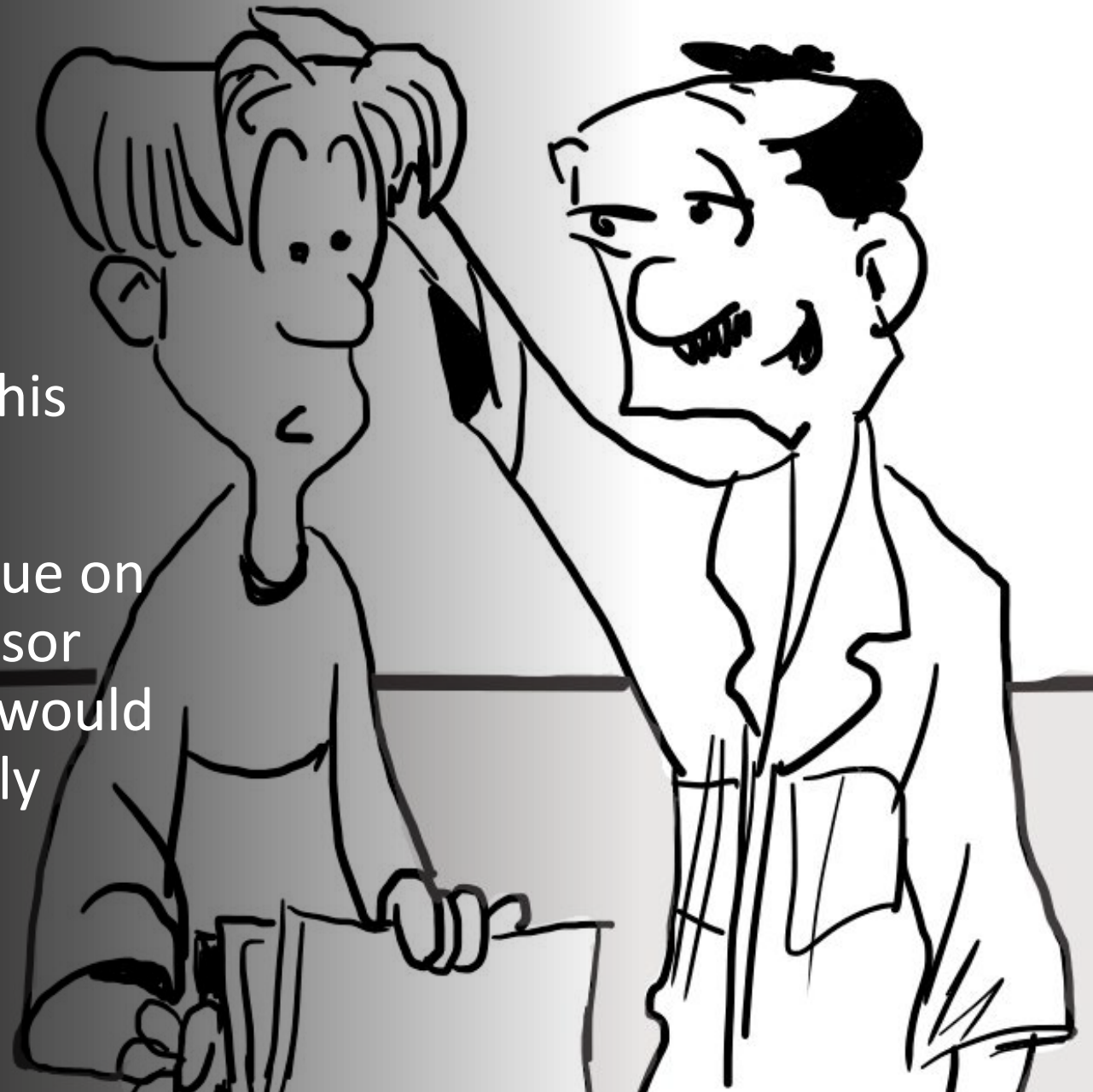
What causes some people to be vulnerable to power attempts?

What causes some people to be vulnerable to power attempts?

Subordinate's Values

Person B's values can influence his susceptibility to influence.

If an employee places a high value on money and believes the supervisor actually controls pay raises, we would expect the employee to be highly susceptible to the supervisor's influence.



What causes some people to be vulnerable to power attempts?



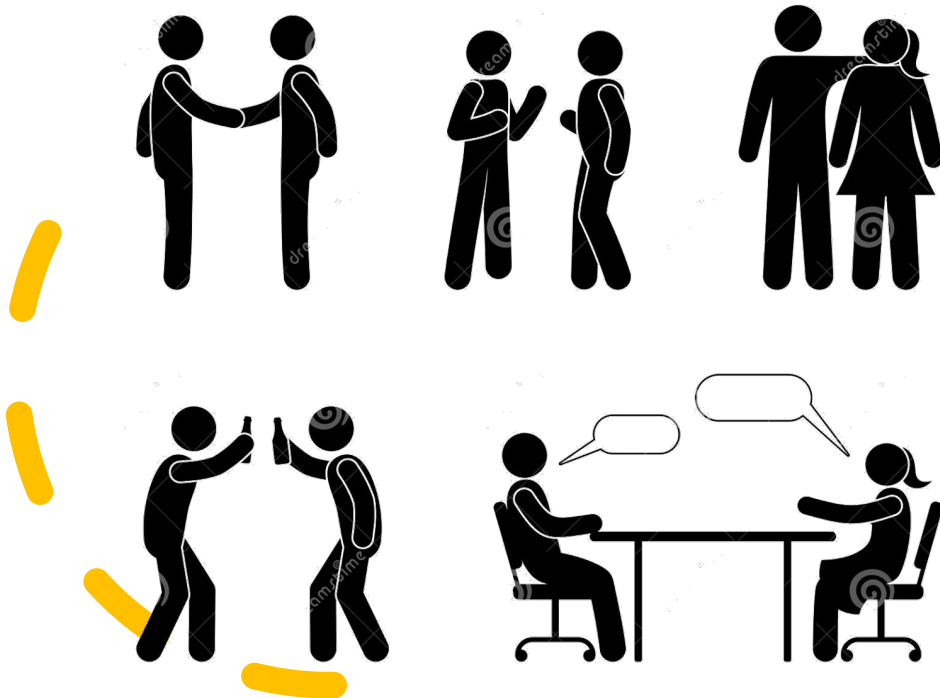
Nature of Relationship

The nature of the relationship between A and B can be a factor in power dependence.

Are A and B peers or superior and subordinate?

Is the job permanent or temporary?

A person on a temporary job, for example, may feel less need to acquiesce, because he won't be holding the position for long.



What causes some people to be vulnerable to power attempts?

Counterpower

B has other sources of power to buffer the effects of A's power. For example, if B is unionized, the union's power may serve to negate A's influence attempts.

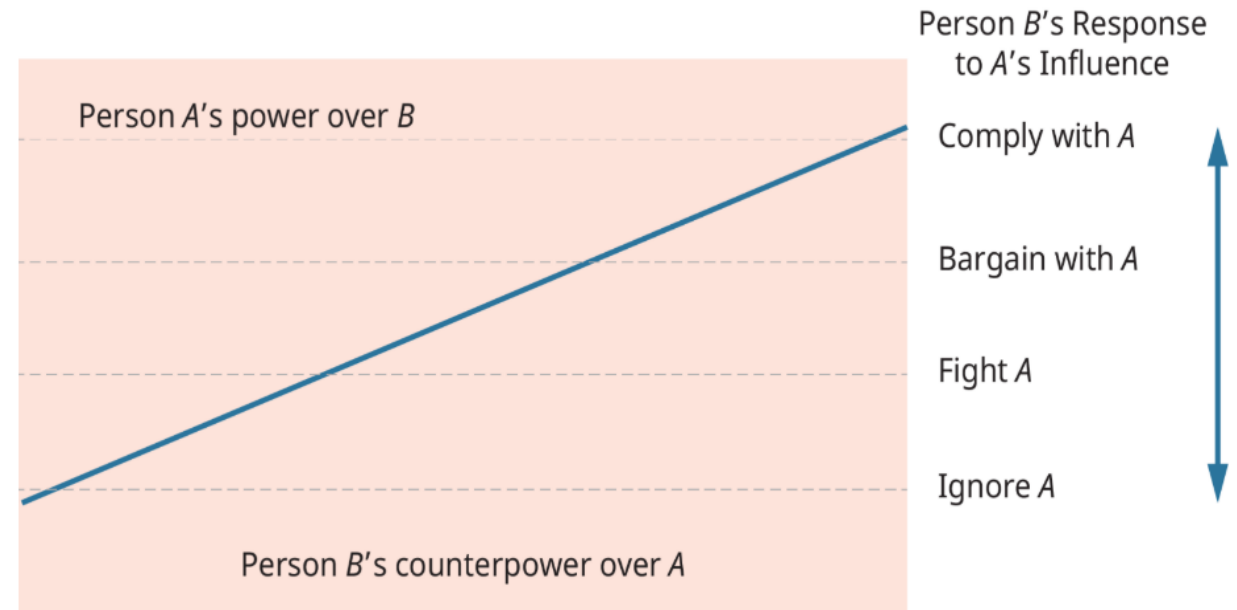


Figure 2 (Credit: Rice University Openstax/Typical Response Patterns in Dyadic Power Relationships/CC BY-NC-SA 4.0).

Uses of Power: Common Power Tactics in Organizations

It is easy to see manifestations of power almost anywhere. In fact, there are a wide variety of power-based methods used to influence others.

We will examine two aspects of the use of power: commonly used **power tactics** and the **ethical use of power**.

Controlling Access to Information

Controlling Access to Person

Selective Use of Objective Criteria

Controlling the Agenda

Bureaucratic Gamesmanship

Using Outside Experts

Coalitions and Alliances

Uses of Power: Ethical Use of Power

Basis of power: Referent power

Guidelines for Use:

- Treat subordinates fairly
- Defend subordinates' interests
- Be sensitive to subordinates' needs, feelings
- Select subordinates similar to oneself
- Engage in role modeling



Uses of Power: Ethical Use of Power

Basis of power: Expert power

Guidelines for Use

- Promote the image of expertise
- Maintain credibility
- Act confident and decisive
- Keep informed
- Recognize employee concerns
- Avoid threatening subordinates' self-esteem



Uses of Power: Ethical Use of Power

Basis of power: Legitimate power

Guidelines for Use

- Be cordial and polite
- Be confident
- Be clear and follow up to verify understanding
- Make sure request is appropriate
- Explain reasons for request
- Follow proper channels
- Exercise power regularly
- Enforce compliance
- Be sensitive to subordinates' concerns



Uses of Power: Ethical Use of Power

Basis of power: Reward power

Guidelines for Use

- Verify compliance
- Make feasible, reasonable requests
- Make only ethical, proper requests
- Offer rewards desired by subordinates
- Offer only credible rewards



Uses of Power: Ethical Use of Power

Basis of Power: Coercive power

Guidelines for Use:

- Inform subordinates of rules and penalties
- Warn before punishing
- Administer punishment consistently and uniformly
- Understand the situation before acting
- Maintain credibility
- Fit punishment to the infraction
- Punish in private



Reflection Question

When you first joined your group,

- What assumptions did you make about the status of different members?
- Where did those assumptions come from?



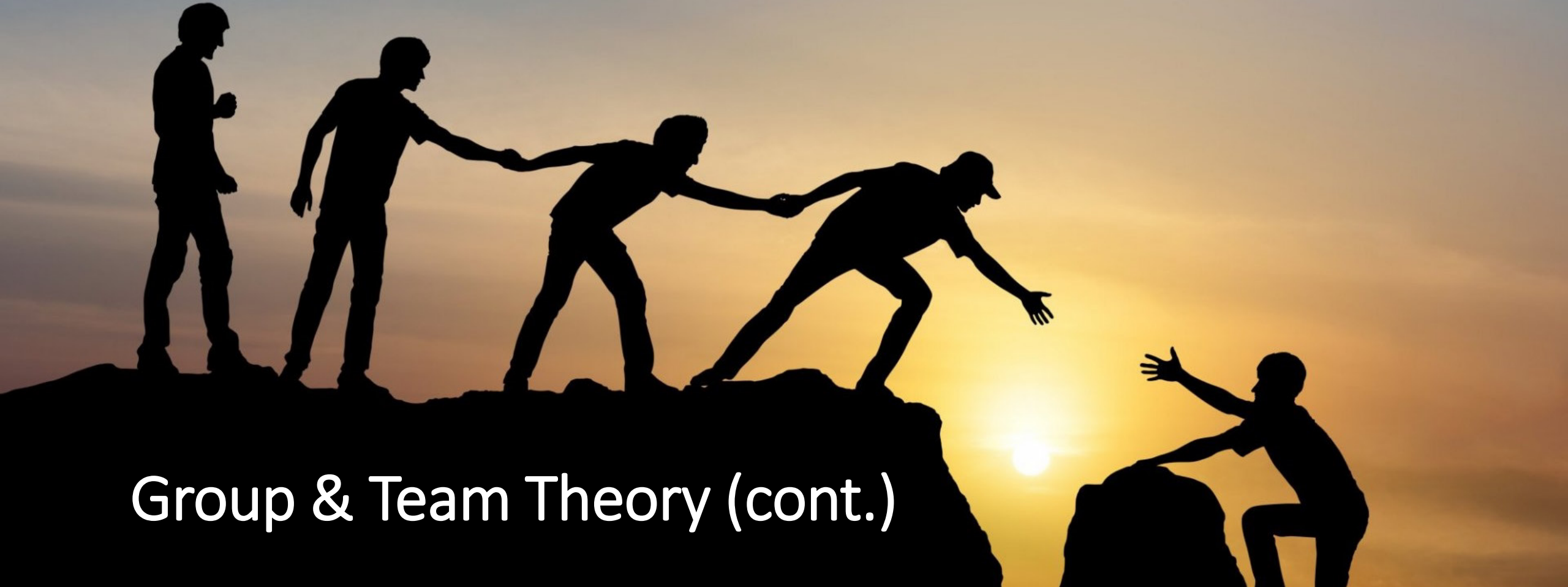
Q&A





Session III

Group & Team Theory (cont.)



Group & Team Theory (cont.)

- 2. Leadership
- 3. Working in Diverse Teams



2. Leadership



The Nature of Leadership

What is the nature of leadership and the leadership process?

Leadership

Leadership is frequently defined as a social (interpersonal) influence relationship between two or more persons who depend on each other to attain certain mutual goals in a group situation.



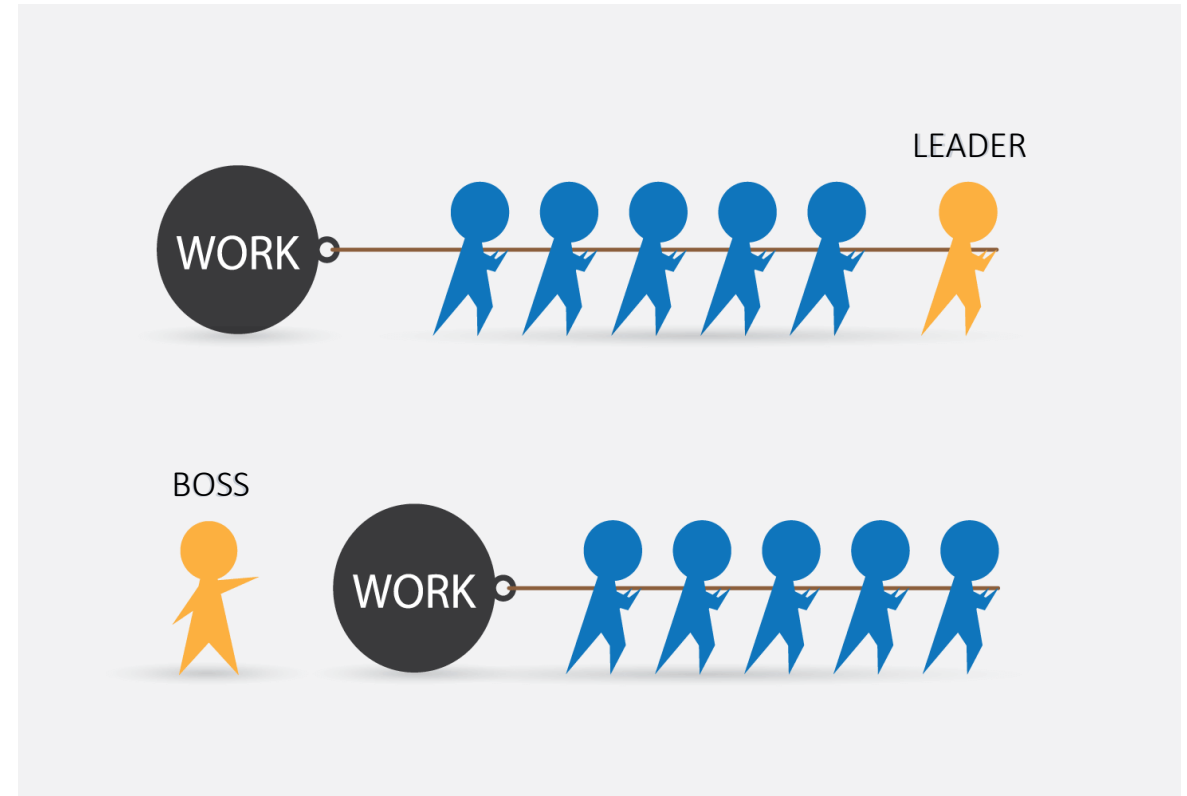
The Nature of Leadership

Leader vs. Manager

The two dual concepts, leader and manager, leadership and management, are *not interchangeable, nor are they redundant.*

The differences between the two can, however, be confusing.

In many instances, *to be a good manager one needs to be an effective leader.*



Effective leadership often necessitates the ability to manage—to set goals; plan, devise, and implement strategy; make decisions and solve problems; and organize and control.

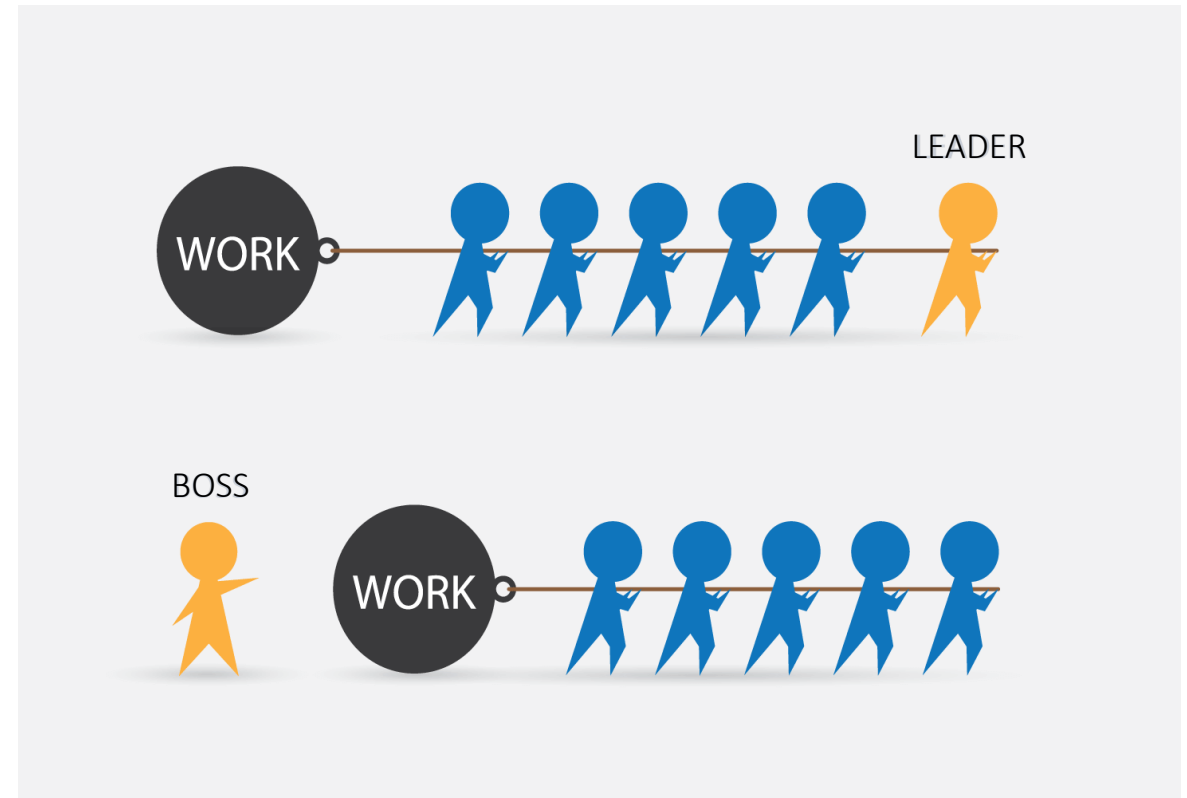
The Nature of Leadership

Leader vs. Manager

Two concepts are defined differently.

- **Management** is defined as a process consisting of planning, organizing, directing, and controlling.
 - **Leadership** is defined as a social (interpersonal) influence relationship between two or more people who are dependent on each another for goal attainment.

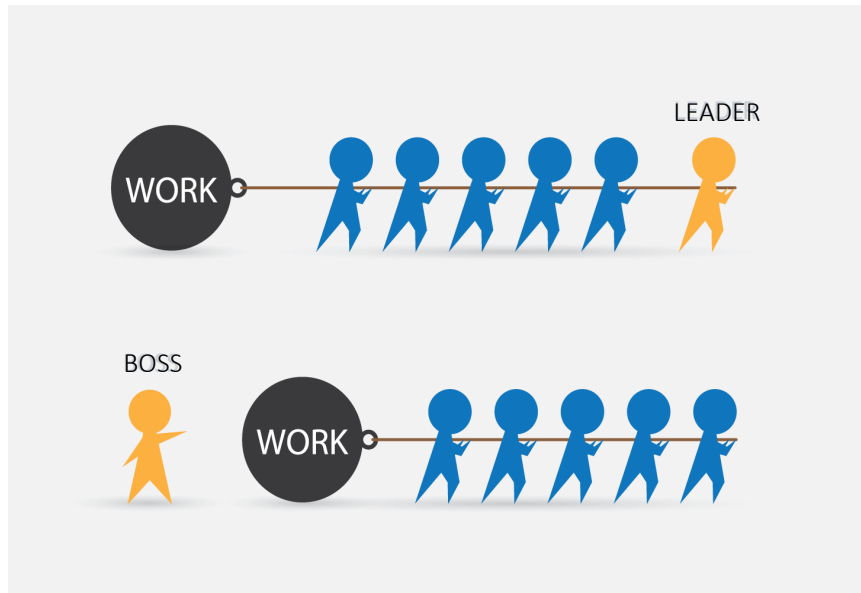
Management and Organizational Behavior,
<https://cnx.org/contents/c3acb2ab-7d5c-45ad-b3cd-e59673fedd4e@8.90:e4112b33-edb8-4e97-943a-859ec40197a7>



The Nature of Leadership

Leader vs. Manager

Managers and Leaders are commonly differentiated in terms of the processes through which they initially come to their position.

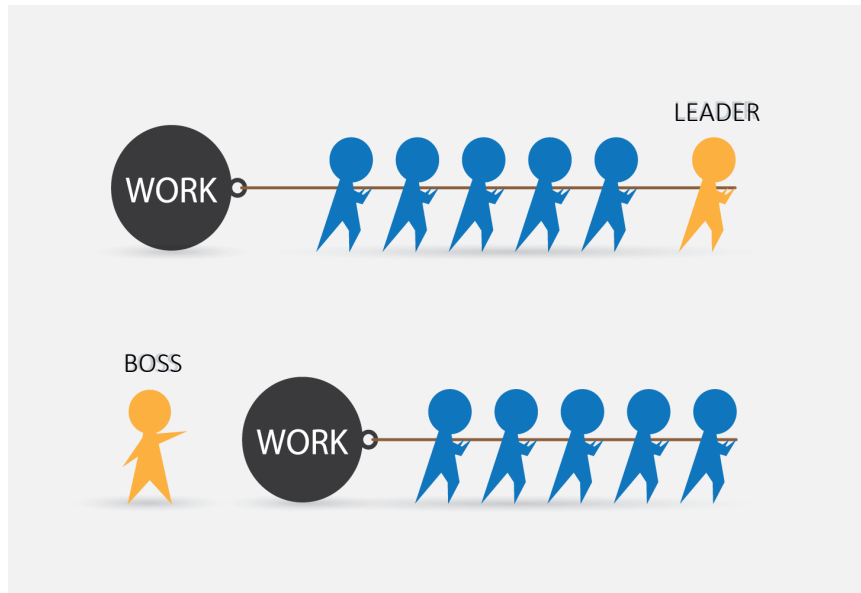


- *Managers* are generally *appointed to their role*.
- *Leadership* per se is *a relationship that revolves around the followers' acceptance or rejection of the leader. Leaders often emerge* out of events that unfold among members of a group.

The Nature of Leadership

Leader vs. Manager

Managers and Leaders often differ in terms of the types and sources of the power they exercise.



Managers commonly derive their power from the larger organization.

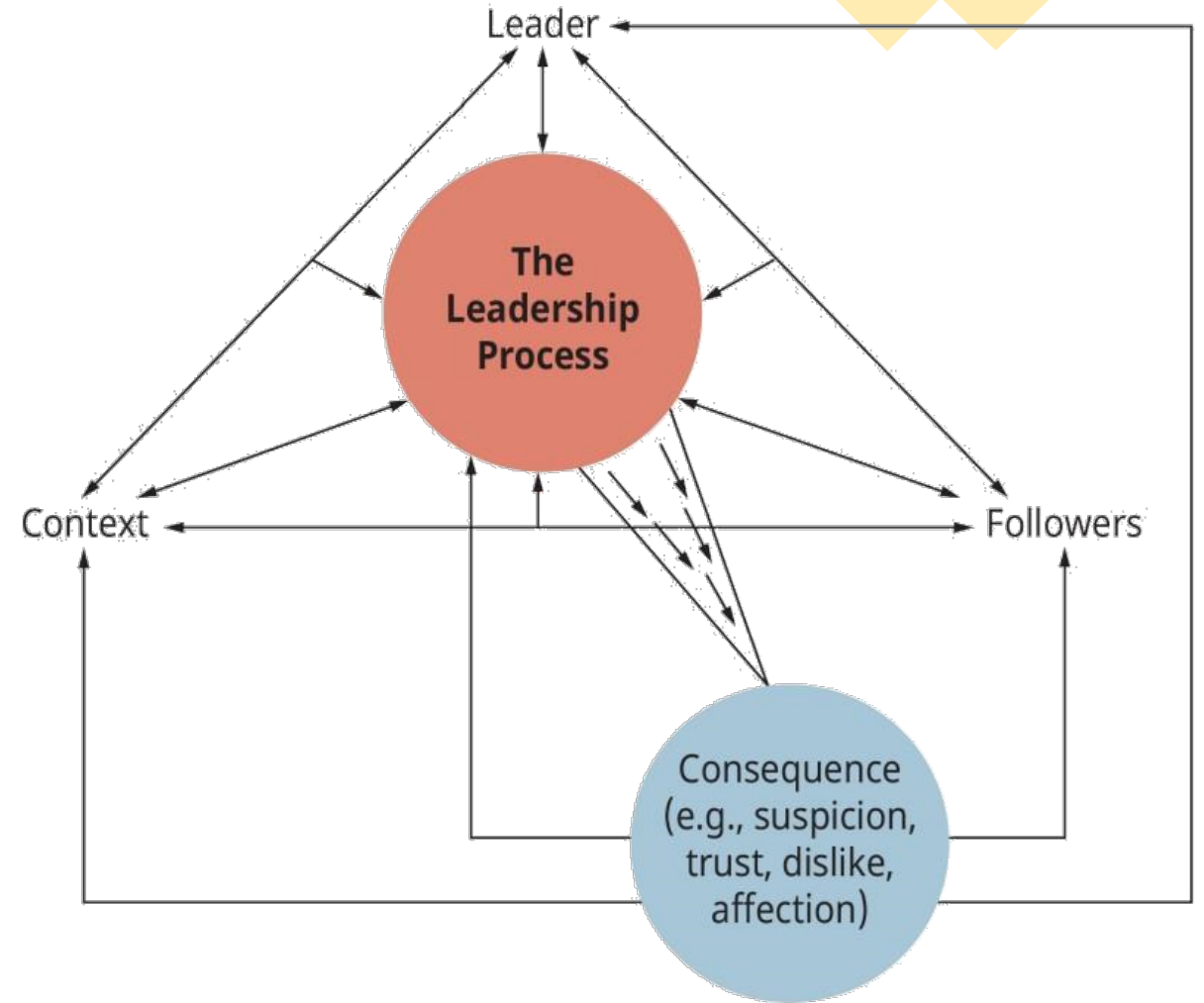
Leaders can also secure power and the ability to exercise influence using carrots and sticks; however, it is much more common for leaders to derive power from followers' perception of their knowledge, personality and attractiveness, and the working relationship that has developed between leaders and followers.

The Nature of Leadership

The Leadership Process

*Leadership is a process, a complex and dynamic exchange relationship built over time **between leader and follower and between leader and the group of followers** who depend on each other **to attain a mutually desired goal.***

Key components to this “working relationship”: the **leader**, the followers, the **context** (situation), the **leadership process** per se, and the **consequences** (outcomes).



The Leadership Process

(Attribution: Copyright Rice University, OpenStax, under CC-BY 4.0 license)

The Nature of Leadership

The Leadership Process



The leader

*Leaders are people who take charge of or guide
the activities of others.*

The Nature of Leadership

The Leadership Process



The Context

Refers to the situation that surrounds the leader and the followers.

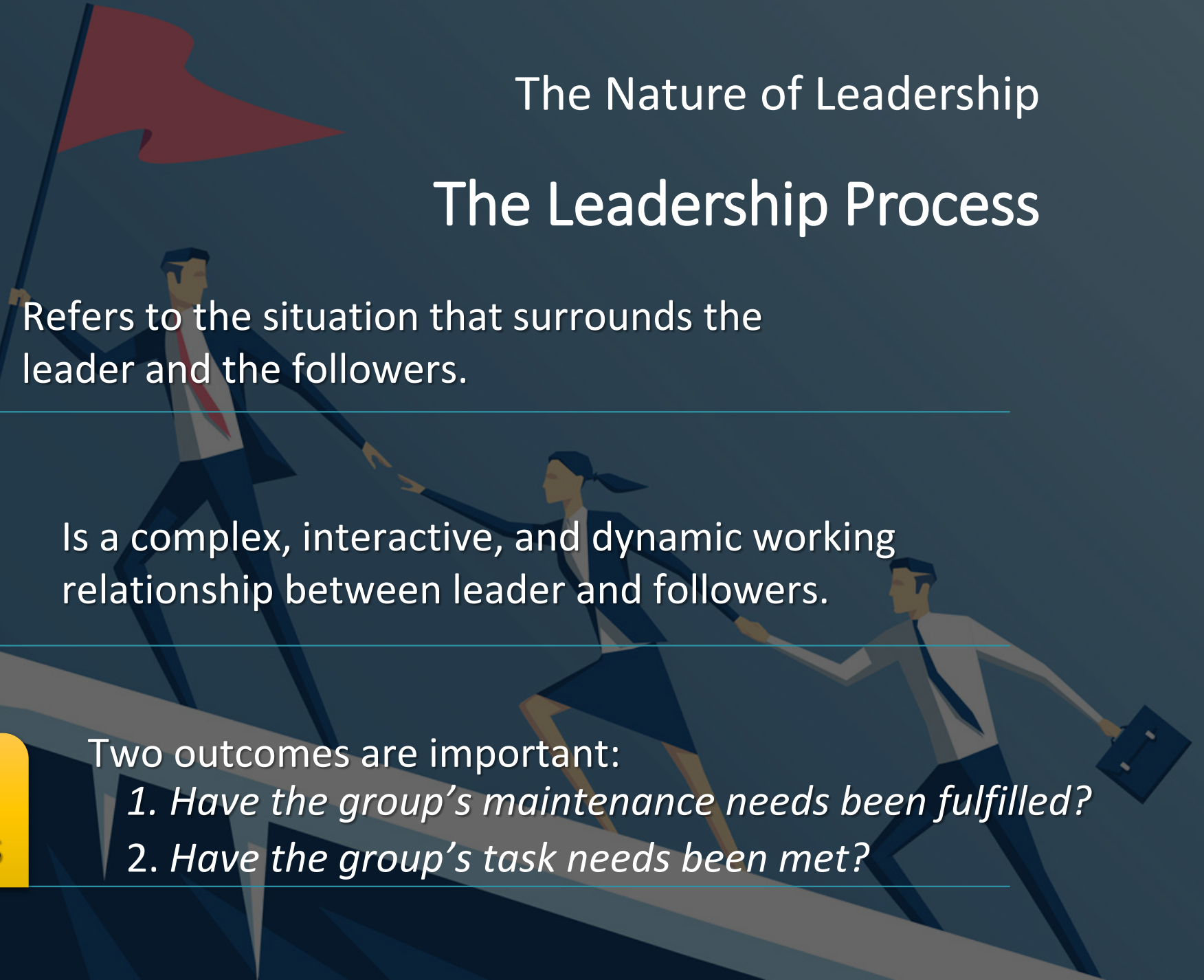
The Process

Is a complex, interactive, and dynamic working relationship between leader and followers.

The Consequences

Two outcomes are important:

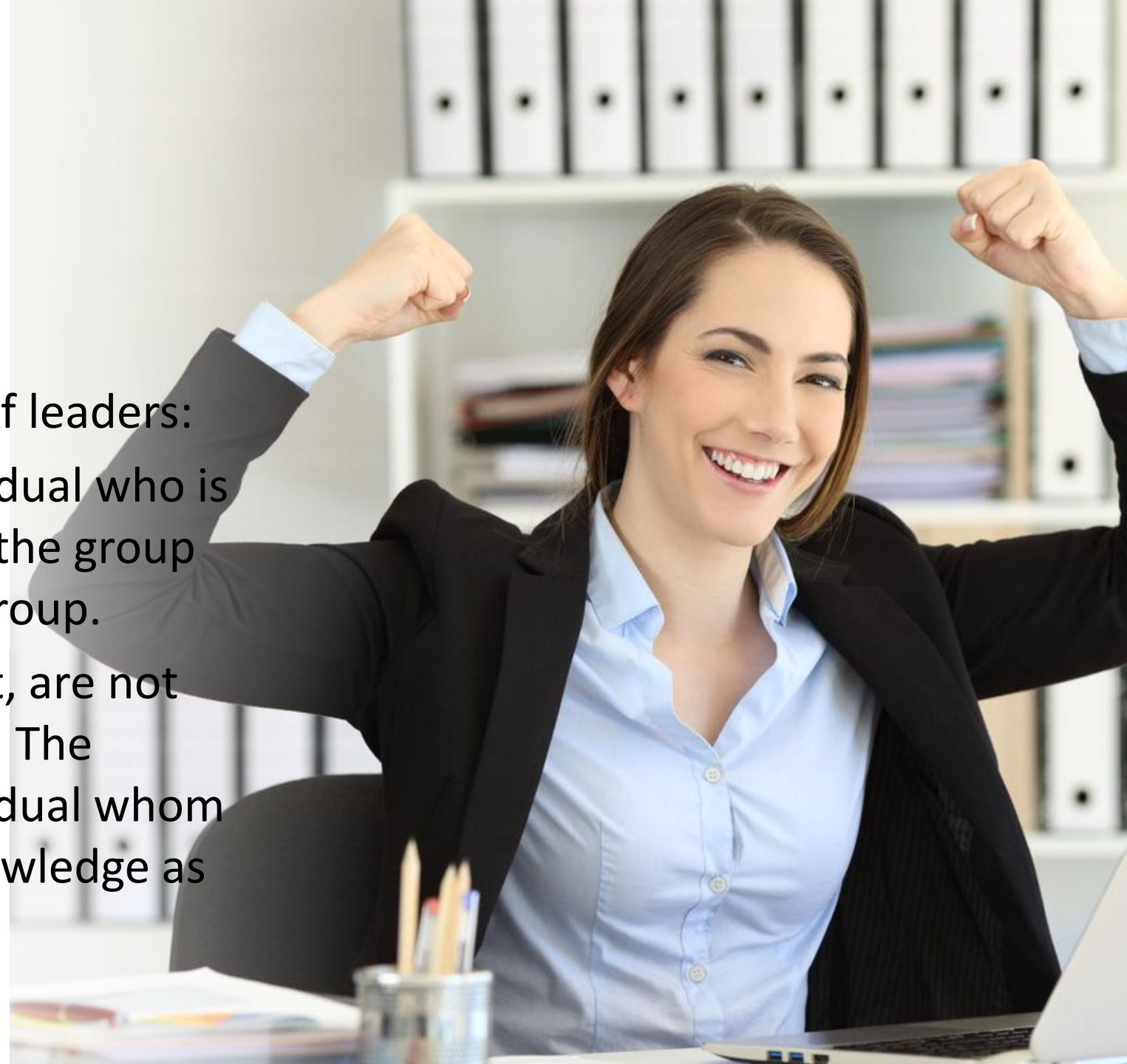
1. *Have the group's maintenance needs been fulfilled?*
2. *Have the group's task needs been met?*



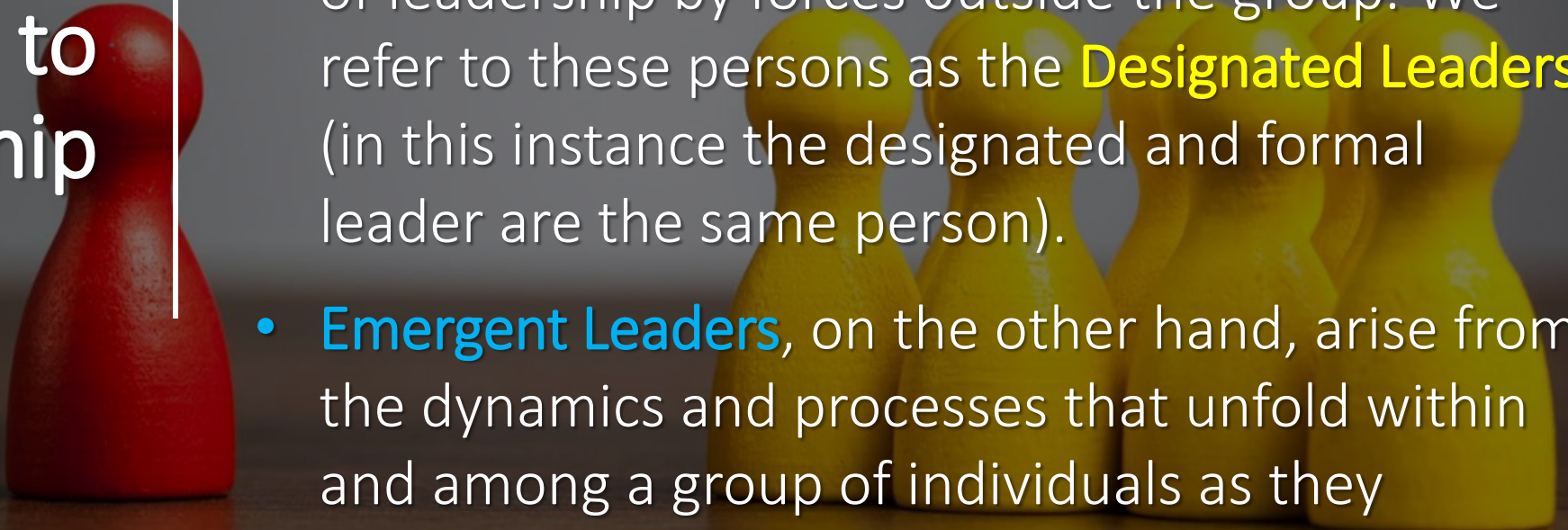
Leader Emergence

Organizations have two kinds of leaders:

- A **formal leader** is that individual who is recognized by those outside the group as the official leader of the group.
- **Informal leaders**, by contrast, are not assigned by the organization. The **informal leader** is that individual whom members of the group acknowledge as their leader.



Paths to Leadership



People come to leadership positions through two dynamics:

- In many instances, people are put into positions of leadership by forces outside the group. We refer to these persons as the **Designated Leaders** (in this instance the designated and formal leader are the same person).
- **Emergent Leaders**, on the other hand, arise from the dynamics and processes that unfold within and among a group of individuals as they endeavor to achieve a collective goal.



DESIGNATED LEADERS (FORMAL LEADER)

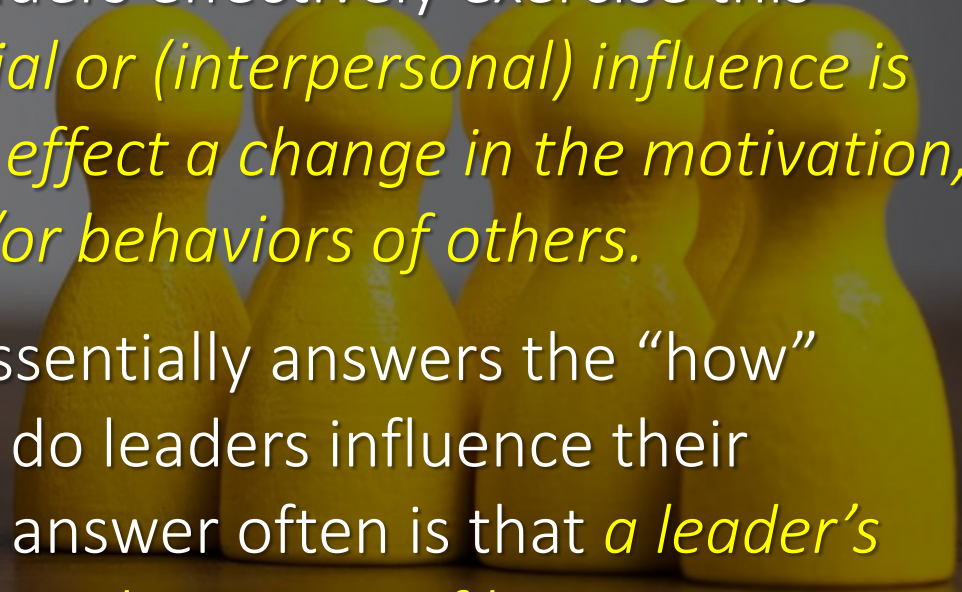
- Selected by group members or an outside authority
- Being designated leader is **no guarantee of leadership ability unless the leader's skills match the group's needs.**

EMERGENT LEADERS (INFORMAL LEADERS)

- Gradually **achieve leadership by helping** the group achieve its goals
- **Emerging** from within a group has the advantage of **relying on expert or referent power.**

Leadership as an Exercise of Influence



- Leadership is the exercise of influence over those who depend on one another for attaining a mutual goal in a group setting.
 - But how do leaders effectively exercise this influence? *Social or (interpersonal) influence is one's ability to effect a change in the motivation, attitudes, and/or behaviors of others.*
 - Power, then, essentially answers the “how” question: How do leaders influence their followers? The answer often is that *a leader's social influence is the source of his power.*
- 

The Leader - Follower Power Relationship



Effective leadership is more likely to occur when the leader's influence flows out of rationality, expertise, moralistic appeal, and/or referent power.



Discussion:

Leadership
Needs in the
21st Century

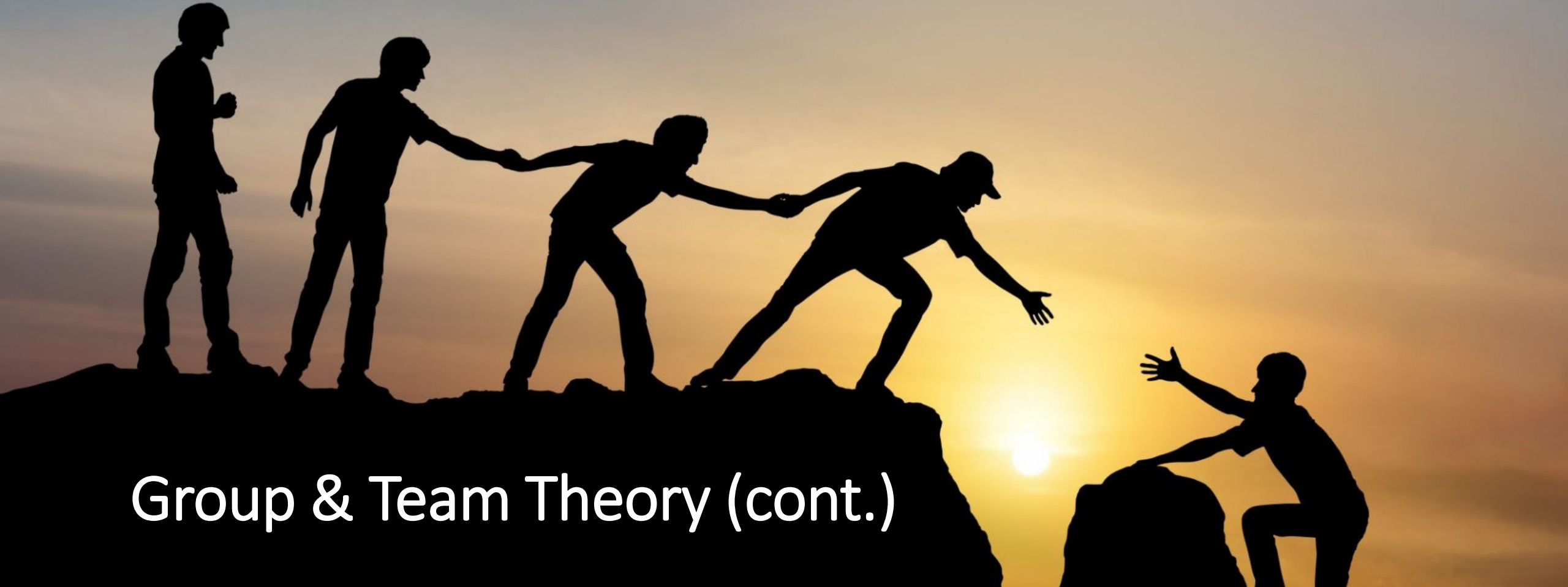


How do different approaches
and styles of leadership impact
what is needed now?

Homework:

Read and write
a reflect essay
on one of the
following
topics:

- **The Trait Approach to Leadership:** What are the trait perspectives on leadership?
- **Behavioral Approaches to Leadership:** What are the behavioral perspectives on leadership?
- **Situational (Contingency) Approaches to Leadership:** Situational (Contingency) Approaches to Leadership: What are the situational perspectives on leadership?
- **Substitutes for and Neutralizers of Leadership:** What does the concept of “substitute for leadership” mean?
- **Transformational, Visionary, and Charismatic Leadership:** What are the characteristics of transactional, transformational, and charismatic leadership?



Group & Team Theory (cont.)

3. Working in Diverse Teams

- Describe how diversity can enhance decision-making and problem-solving
- Identify challenges and best practices for working with multicultural teams
 - Define conflict
- Differentiate between functional and dysfunctional conflict
- Recognize various types of conflict in groups
 - Describe the conflict process
- Identify and apply strategies for preventing or reducing conflict in groups

Learning Objective

A photograph of three people of diverse backgrounds working together at a wooden table. On the left, a man with dark hair and glasses, wearing a blue and black plaid shirt, is looking at a laptop. In the center, a woman with long blonde dreadlocks, wearing a black blazer, is pointing at the laptop screen. Behind her, a woman with curly brown hair, wearing a purple top and a patterned scarf, is also looking at the laptop. The laptop has a red logo that says 'ANALERO' with a stylized 'M' below it. In the background, there is a whiteboard with some faint red diagrams and text.

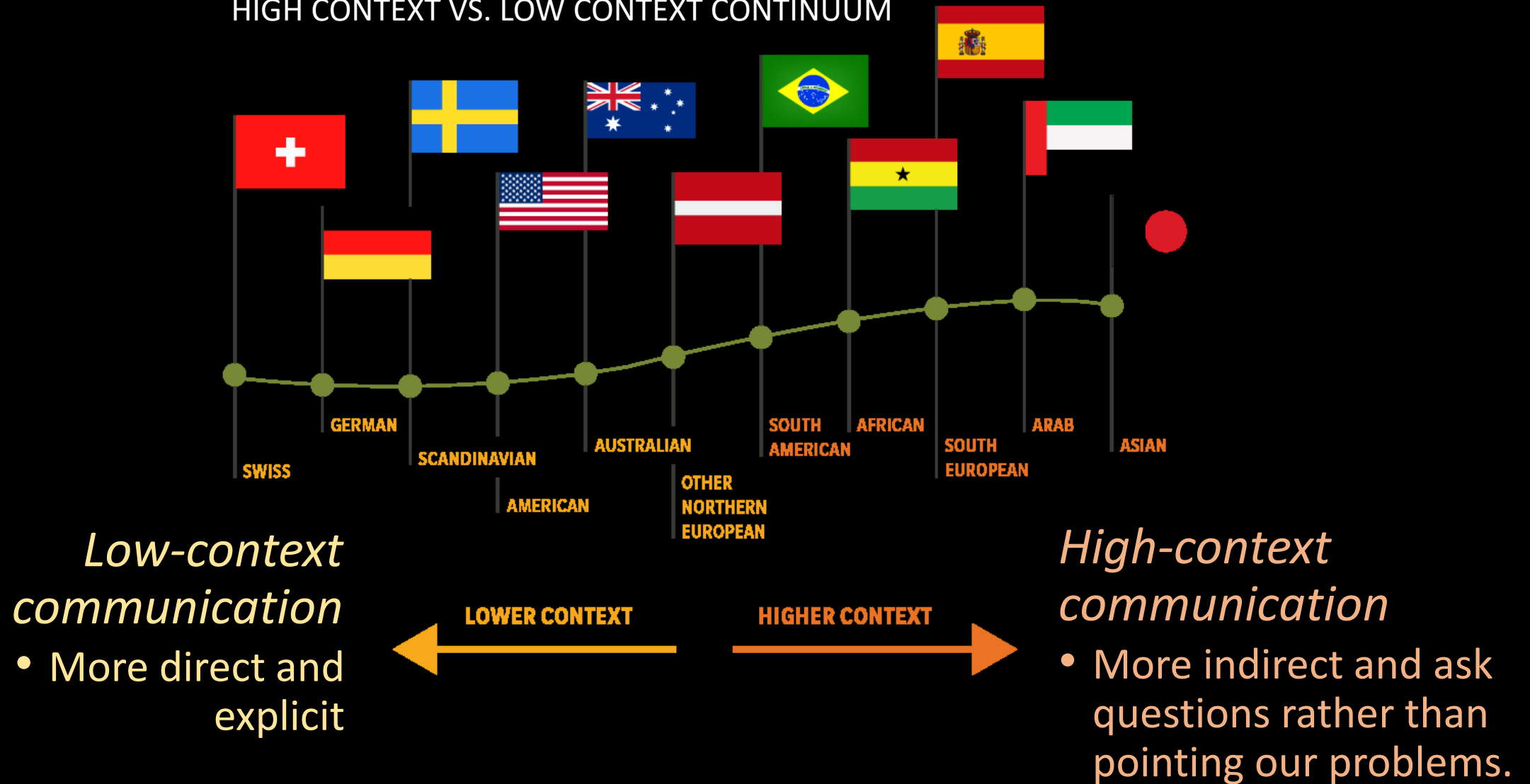
Does Team Diversity Enhance Decision Making and Problem Solving?

Teams made up of diverse members tend to perform better than teams of similar backgrounds.

Here, the Women of Color in Technology work on a project. The tech industry has been criticized for the lack of diversity among its ranks, and groups like the Women of Color in Technology are looking to change that.

(Credit: [WOCin Tech Chat/CC BY 2.0](#))

HIGH CONTEXT VS. LOW CONTEXT CONTINUUM



Challenges and Best Practices for Working with Multicultural Team

Developing Cultural Intelligence

Cultural intelligence is a competency and a skill that enables individuals to function effectively in cross-cultural environments.

Cultural intelligence develops as people become more aware of the influence of culture and more capable of adapting their behavior to the norms of other cultures.



Best practices recommended
for honing cross-cultural skills.

“broaden your mind” - expand
your own cultural channels (travel,
movies, books) and surround
yourself with people from other
cultures.

**“develop your cross-cultural skills through
practice”** and experiential learning.



Three sources of cultural intelligence for becoming more adept in cross-cultural skills and understanding: **head**, **body**, and **heart** (Mosakowski, 2004):



We first learn about the beliefs, customs, and taboos of foreign cultures via the **HEAD**.

This is the cognitive component of cultural intelligence.



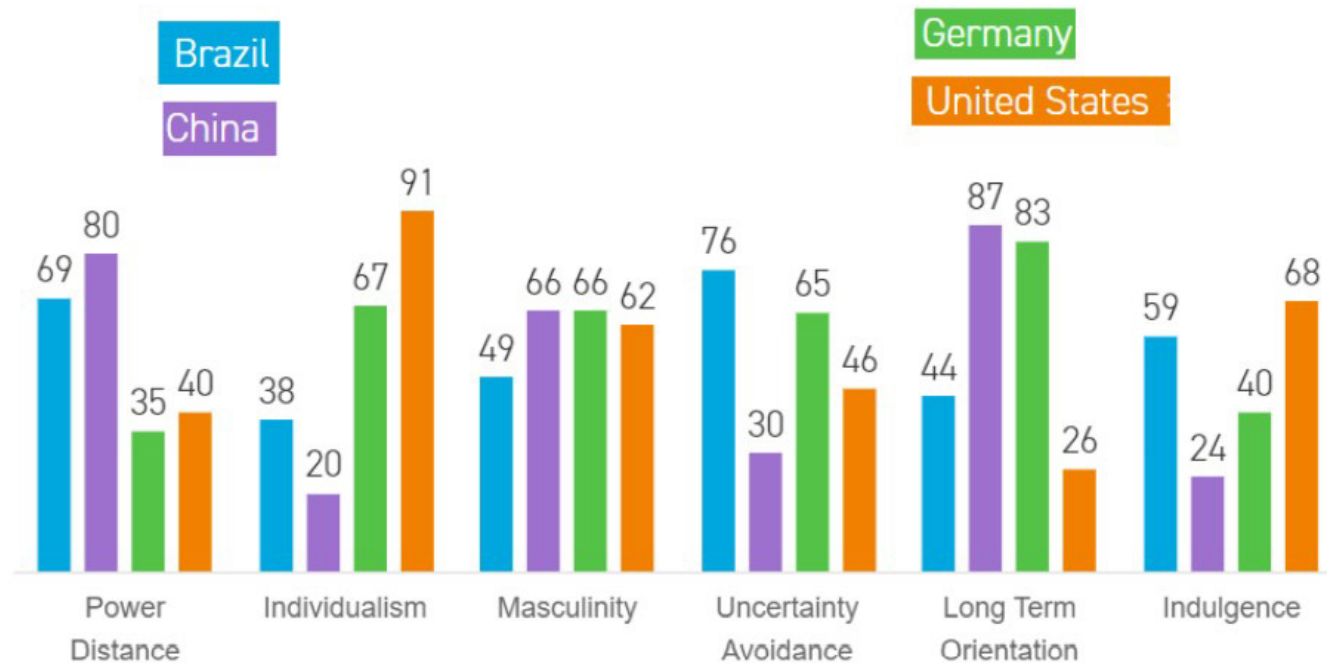
The **BODY** involves more commitment and experimentation with the new culture.

This physical component (demeanor, eye contact, posture, accent) shows a deeper level of understanding of the new culture and its physical manifestations.



The **HEART** deals with a person's own confidence in their ability to adapt to and deal well with cultures outside of their own.

Heart really speaks to one's own level of emotional commitment and motivation to understand the new culture.



Hofstede's cultural dimensions theory. Comparison of 4 countries: US, China, Germany and Brazil in all 6 dimensions of the model.

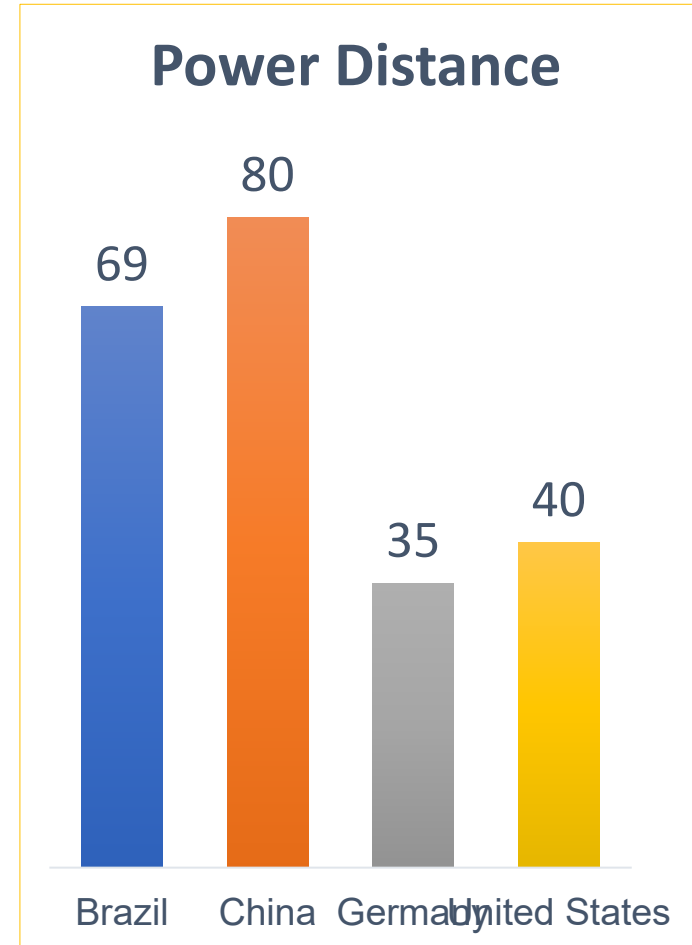
Divergent Cultural Dimensions

- Power Distance
 - Individualism
 - Masculinity
- Uncertainty Avoidance
- Long Term Orientation
 - Time Orientation

POWER DISTANCE

Low-power distance cultures: people relate to one another more as equals and less as a reflection of dominant or subordinate roles, regardless of their actual formal roles as employee and manager (Geert Hofstede).

High-power distance culture: people are less likely to challenge the decision, to provide an alternative, or to give input. Less powerful people are more likely to accept decisions without comment, even if they have a concern or know there is a significant problem.

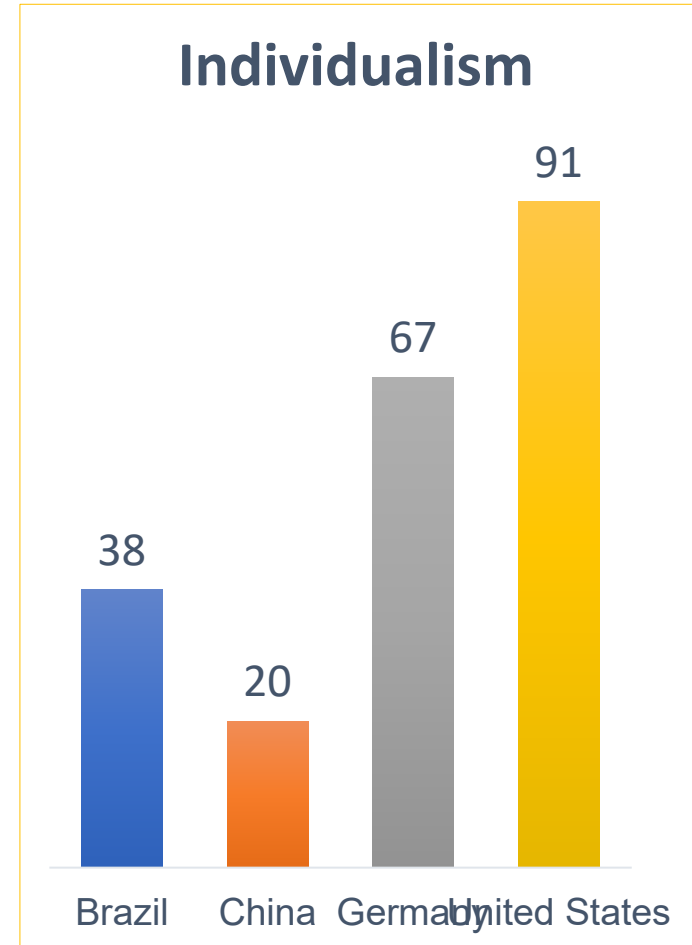


INDIVIDUALISM

Individualism: People in **individualistic cultures** value individual freedom and personal independence, and cultures always have stories to reflect their values. In individualistic cultures like the United States, people perceived their world primarily from their own viewpoint. They perceived themselves as empowered individuals, capable of making their own decisions, and able to make an impact on their own lives.

Collectivist cultures including many in Asia and South America, focus on the needs of the nation, community, family, or group of workers.

(Hofstede, 1982)

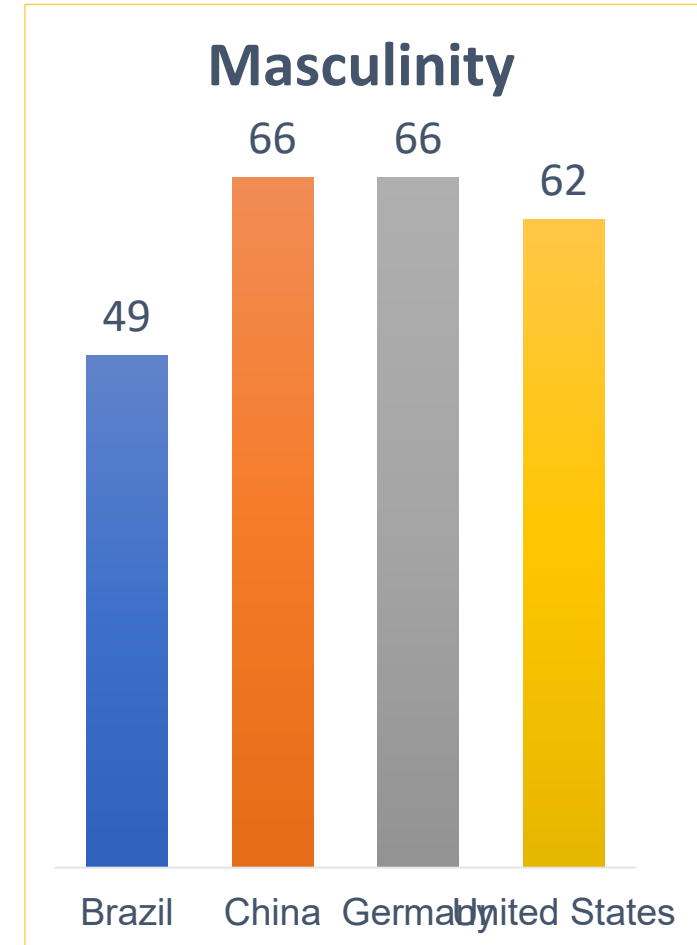


MASCULINITY

The masculine-feminine dichotomy is the extent to which the culture values certain traits that may be considered **masculine** or **feminine** (Hofstede, 2009).

“The assertive pole has been called ‘masculine’ and the modest, caring pole ‘feminine.’

The women in feminine countries have the same modest, caring values as the men; in the masculine countries they are somewhat assertive and competitive, but not as much as the men, so that these countries show a gap between men’s values and women’s values” (Hofstede, 2009).

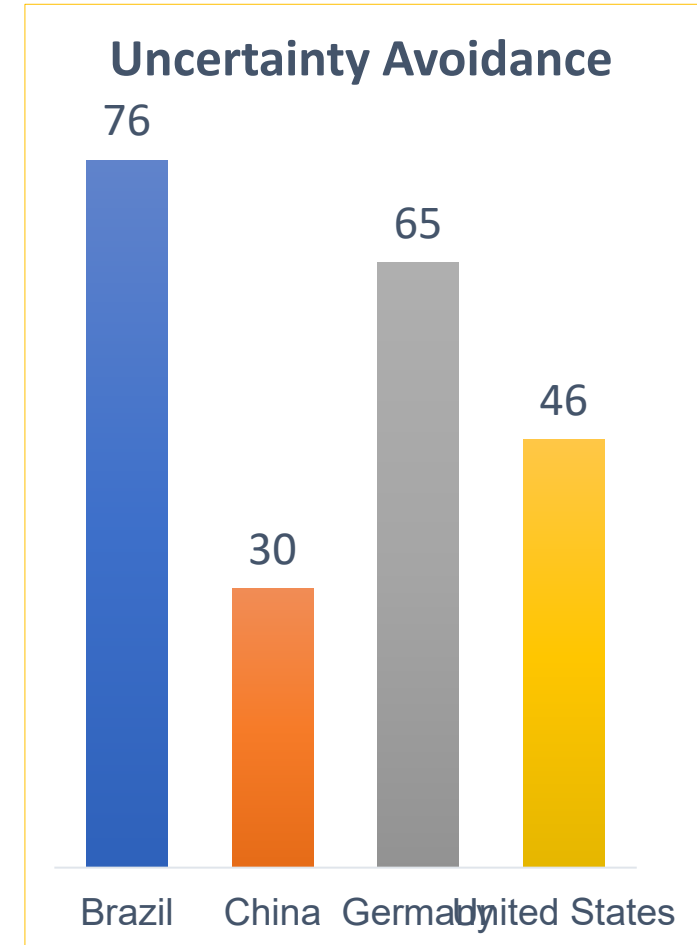


UNCERTAINTY AVOIDANCE

Some cultures, such as the United States and Britain, are **highly tolerant of uncertainty**, while others go to great lengths to reduce the element of surprise.

Cultures in the Arab world, for example, are **high in uncertainty avoidance**; they tend to be **resistant to change and reluctant to take risks**.

Whereas a U.S. business negotiator might enthusiastically agree to try a new procedure, the Egyptian counterpart would likely refuse to get involved until all the details are worked out.

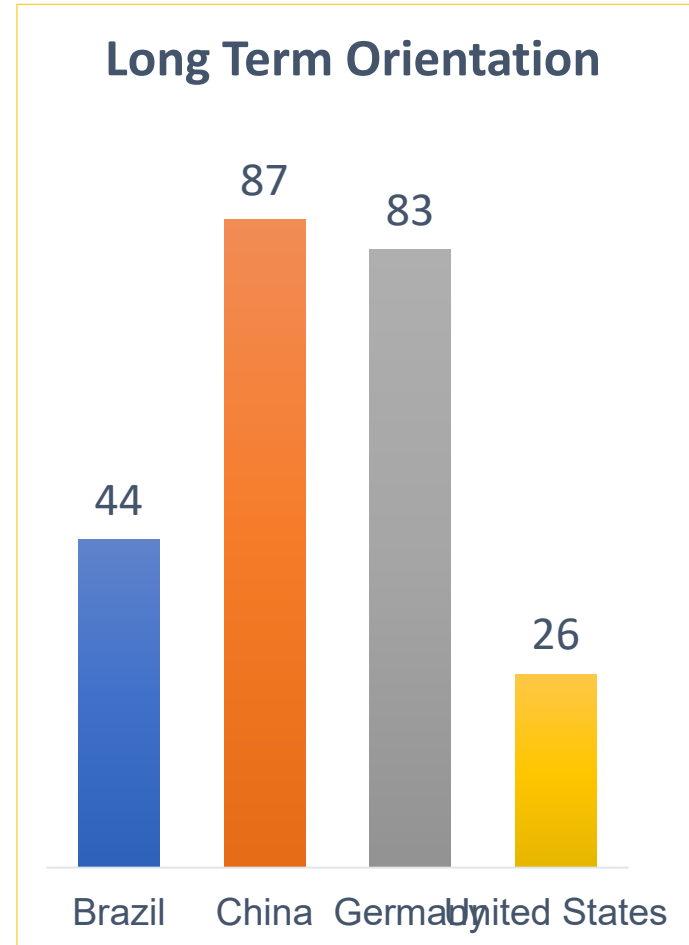


LONG TERM ORIENTATION

In short-term orientated culture, people place greater emphasis on reciprocation of greetings, gifts, and rewards.

While there may be a respect for tradition, there is also an emphasis on *personal representation and honor, a reflection of identity and integrity. Personal stability and consistency* are also valued in a short-term oriented culture, contributing to an overall sense of predictability and familiarity.

Long-term orientation is often marked by persistence, thrift and frugality, and an order to relationships based on age and status. A sense of shame for the family and community is also observed across generations. What an *individual does reflects on the family and is carried by immediate and extended family members.*



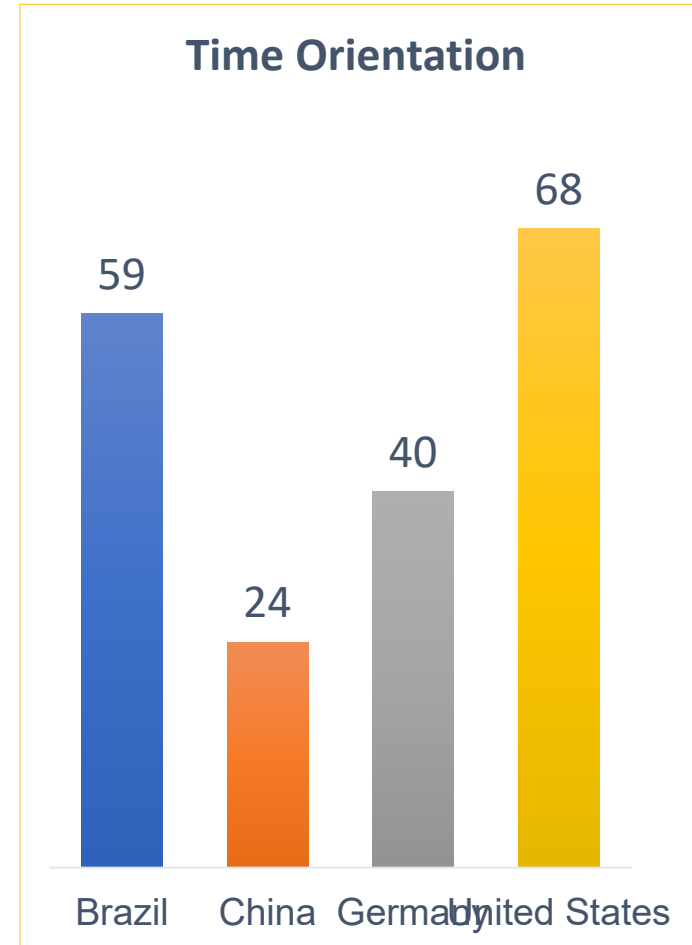
Time Orientation

Monochronic time-oriented cultures consider one thing at a time, whereas **polychronic time-oriented cultures schedule many things at one time, and time is considered in a more fluid sense.**

In **monochromatic time**, interruptions are to be avoided, and everything has its own specific time. The U.S, Germany, and Switzerland are often noted as countries that value a monochromatic time orientation.

Polychromatic time looks a little more complicated, with business and family mixing with dinner and dancing. Greece, Italy, Chile, and Saudi Arabia are countries of polychromatic timing; business meetings may be scheduled at a fixed time, but when they actually begin may be another story.

(Edward T. Hall and Mildred Reed Hall, 1987)



- 
- Low-Power versus High-Power Distance
 - Masculine versus Feminine Orientation
 - Uncertainty-Accepting Cultures versus Uncertainty-Rejecting Cultures
 - Short-Term versus Long-Term Orientation
 - Time Orientation

Homework:
reading

Review & Reflection Questions

- Why are diverse teams better at decision-making and problem-solving?
- What are some of the challenges that multicultural teams face?
- How might you further cultivate your own cultural intelligence?
- What are some potential points of divergence between cultures?



it's
Q&A
TIME!



Session III.
Group & Team Theory (cont.)

4. Conflict and Cohesion in Groups



Learning Objectives

- Define conflict
- Differentiate between functional and dysfunctional conflict
- Recognize various types of conflict in groups
- Describe the conflict process
- Identify and apply strategies for preventing or reducing conflict in groups

Definitions of Conflict

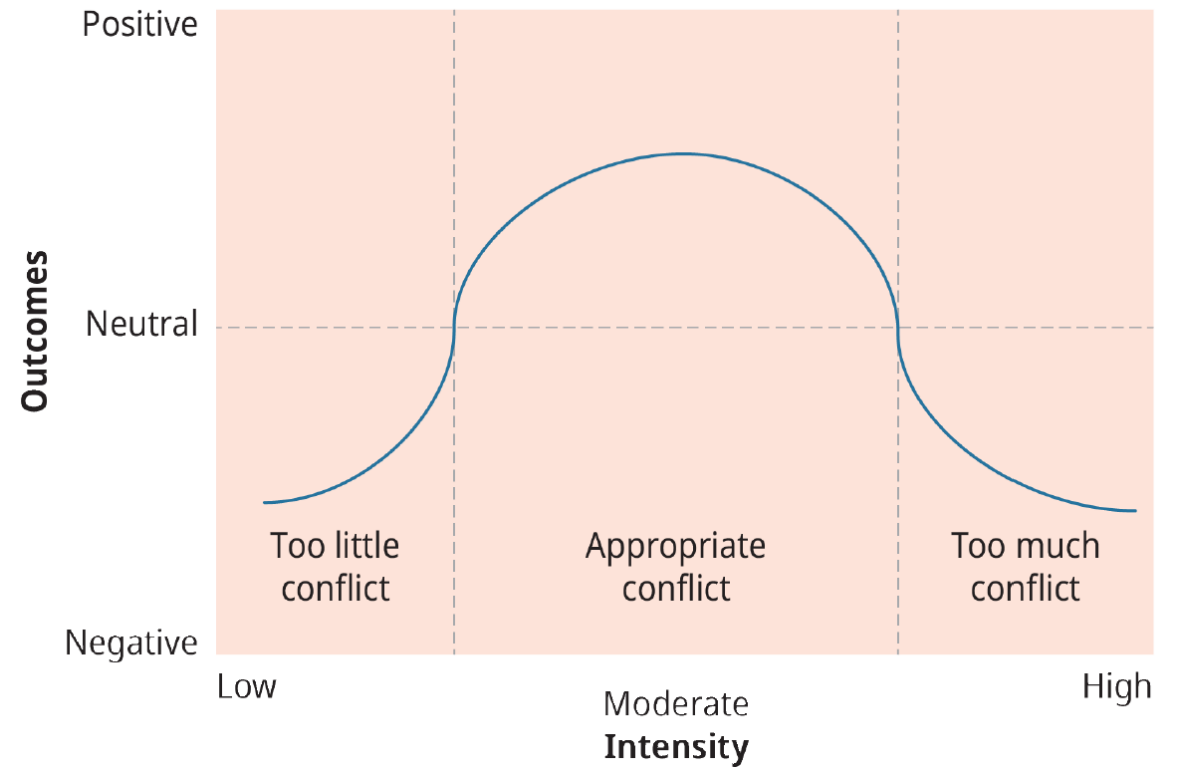
Conflict is defined as an expressed struggle between interdependent parties over goals which they perceive as incompatible or resources which they perceive to be insufficient (Hocker & Wilmot, 2001).

- First, conflict must be expressed.
- Second, conflict takes place between or among parties who are interdependent - that is, who need each other to accomplish something.
- Finally, conflict involves clashes over what people want or over the means for them to achieve it.



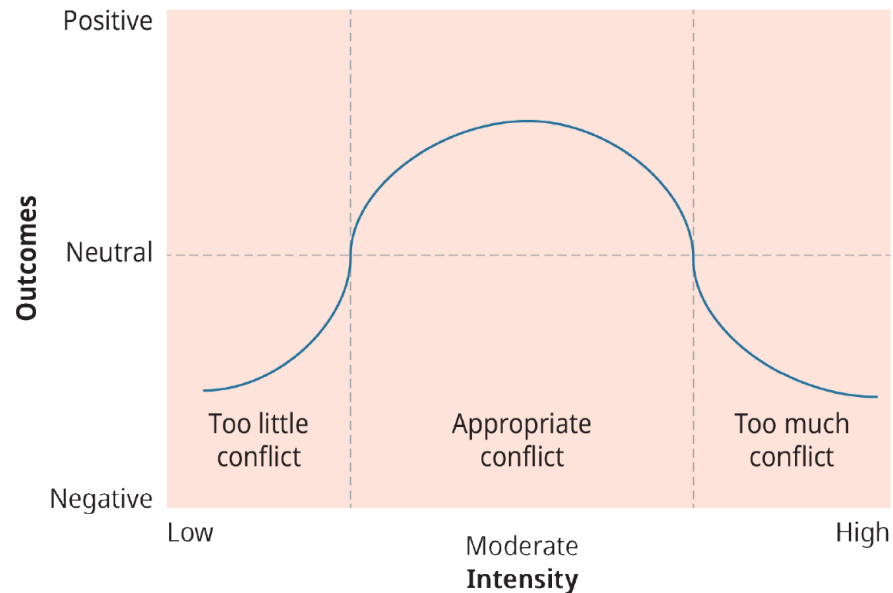
The Positive and Negative Sides of Conflict

- Conflict can stimulate innovation and change.
- Conflict can help individuals and group members grow and develop self-identities.



The Relationship Between Conflict Intensity and Outcomes. Adapted from Brown (1986). (Credit: Rice University/OpenStax/CC BY-NC-SA 4.0)

The Positive and Negative Sides of Conflict



The Relationship Between Conflict Intensity and Outcomes. Adapted from Brown (1986). (Credit: Rice University/OpenStax/CC BY-NC-SA 4.0)

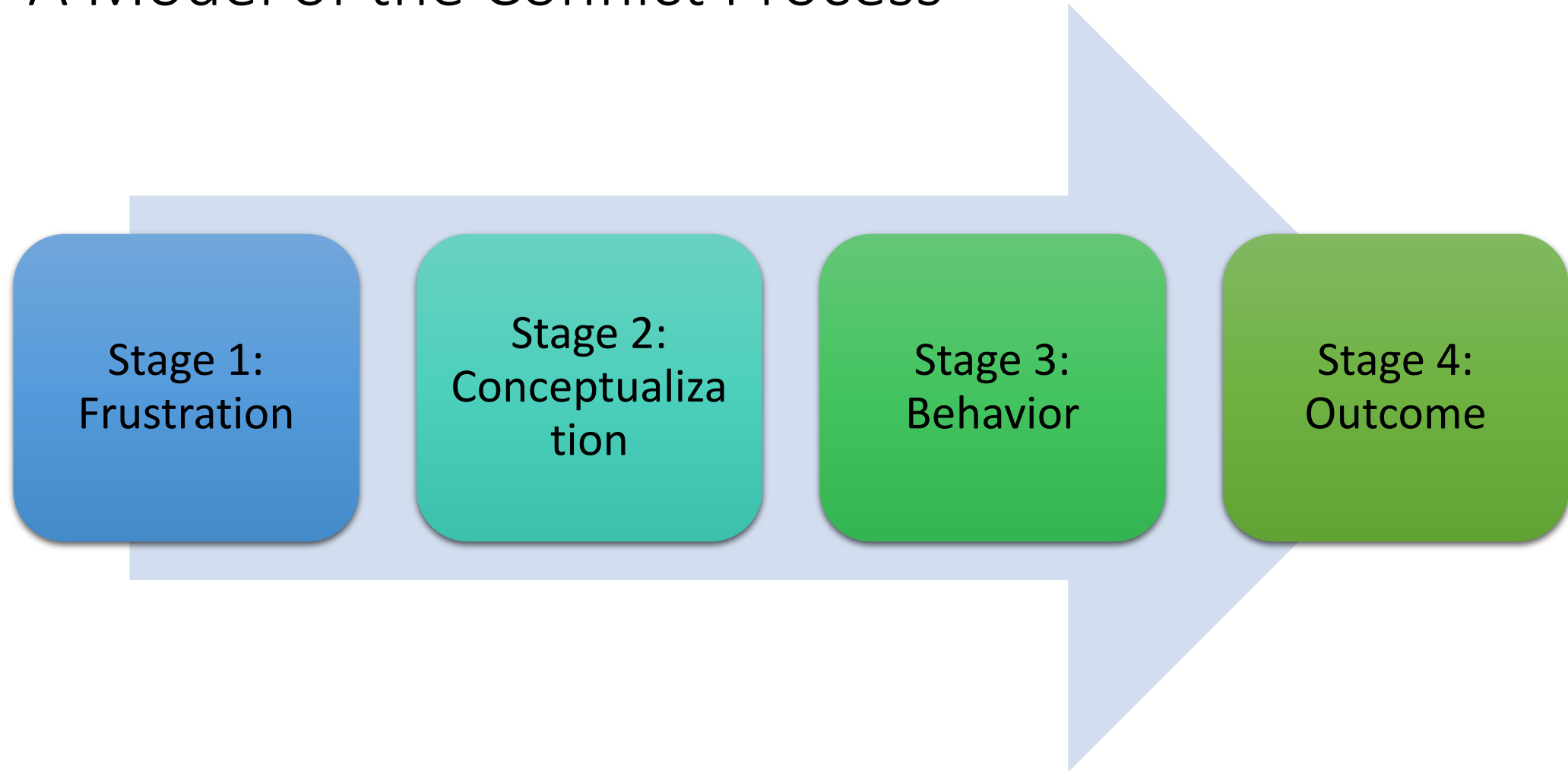
- Conflict, which aims at a resolution of tension between antagonists, is likely to have **stabilizing and integrative functions** for the relationship.
- By **permitting immediate and direct expression** of rival claims, such social systems can readjust their structures by **eliminating their sources of dissatisfaction**.
- The multiple conflicts which they experience may serve to **eliminate the causes for dissociation and to reestablish unity**.
- These systems avail themselves, through the toleration and institutionalization of conflict, of an important stabilizing mechanism.

Types of Conflict

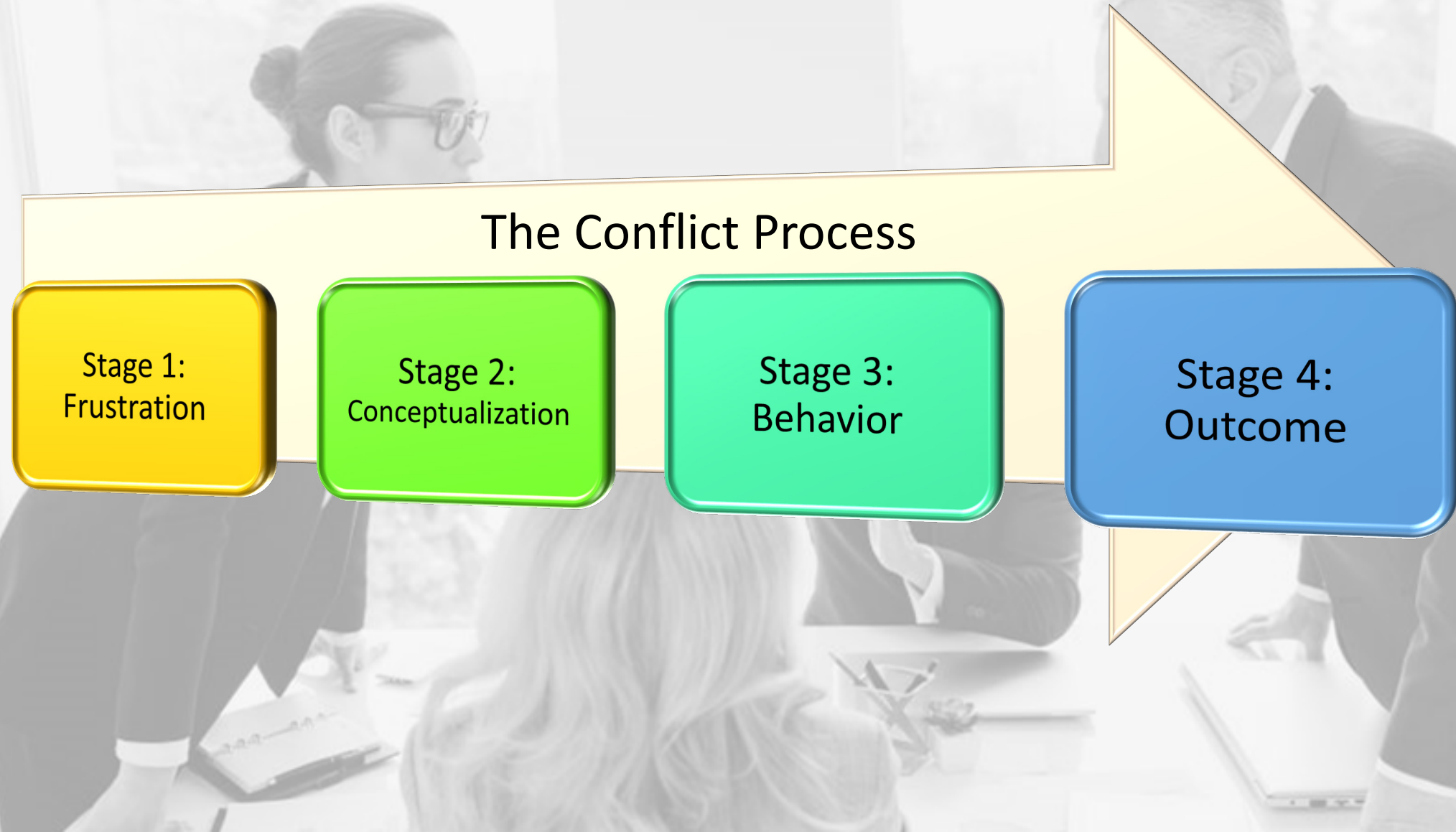
- Conflicts of substance
- Conflicts of value
- Conflicts of process
- Conflicts of misperceived differences
- Relationship conflicts



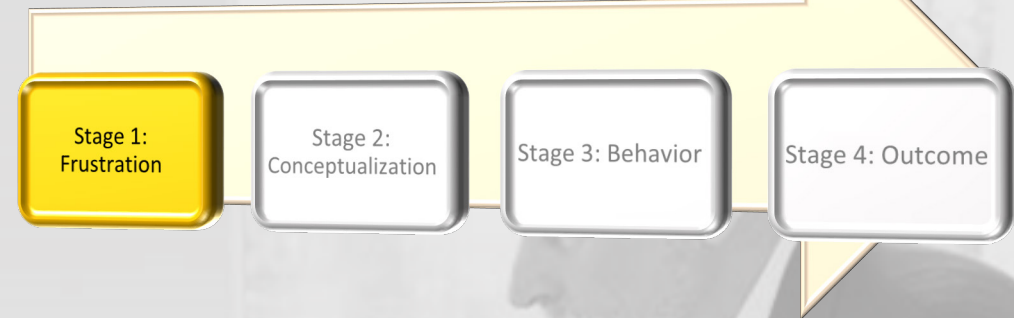
A Model of the Conflict Process



A Model of the Conflict Process



A Model of the Conflict Process



STAGE 1: FRUSTRATION

- Conflict situations originate when an individual or group feels frustration in the pursuit of important goals.
- This frustration may be caused by a wide variety of factors, including disagreement over performance goals, failure to get a promotion or pay raise, a fight over scarce economic resources, new rules or policies, and so forth.
- In fact, conflict can be traced to frustration over almost anything a group or individual cares about.

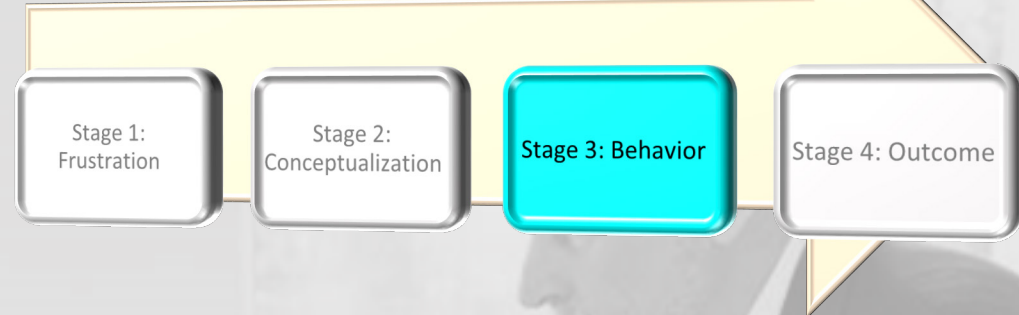
A Model of the Conflict Process



STAGE 2: CONCEPTUALIZATION

- In this stage, parties to the conflict attempt to understand the nature of the problem, what they themselves want as a resolution, what they think their opponents want as a resolution, and various strategies they feel each side may employ in resolving the conflict.
- This stage is really the problem-solving and strategy phase.

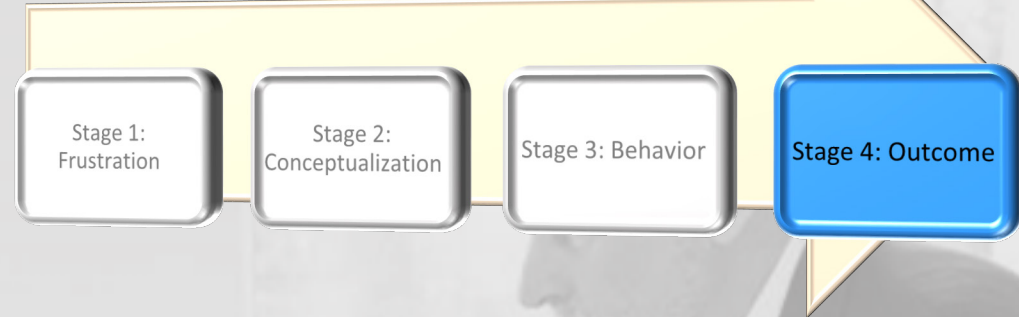
A Model of the Conflict Process



STAGE 3: BEHAVIOR

- As a result of the conceptualization process, parties to a conflict attempt to implement their resolution mode by competing or accommodating in the hope of resolving problems.
- A major task here is determining how best to proceed strategically. That is, what tactics will the party use to attempt to resolve the conflict?
- Thomas has identified five modes for conflict resolution: (1) competing, (2) collaborating, (3) compromising, (4) avoiding, and (5) accommodating.

A Model of the Conflict Process



STAGE 4: OUTCOME

- In this stage, both sides determine the extent to which a satisfactory resolution or outcome has been achieved.
- Where one party to the conflict does not feel satisfied or feels only partially satisfied, the seeds of discontent are sown for a later conflict.
- One unresolved conflict episode can easily set the stage for a second episode. Action aimed at achieving quick and satisfactory resolution is vital; failure to initiate such action leaves the possibility (more accurately, the probability) that new conflicts will soon emerge.

Five Modes of Resolving Conflict

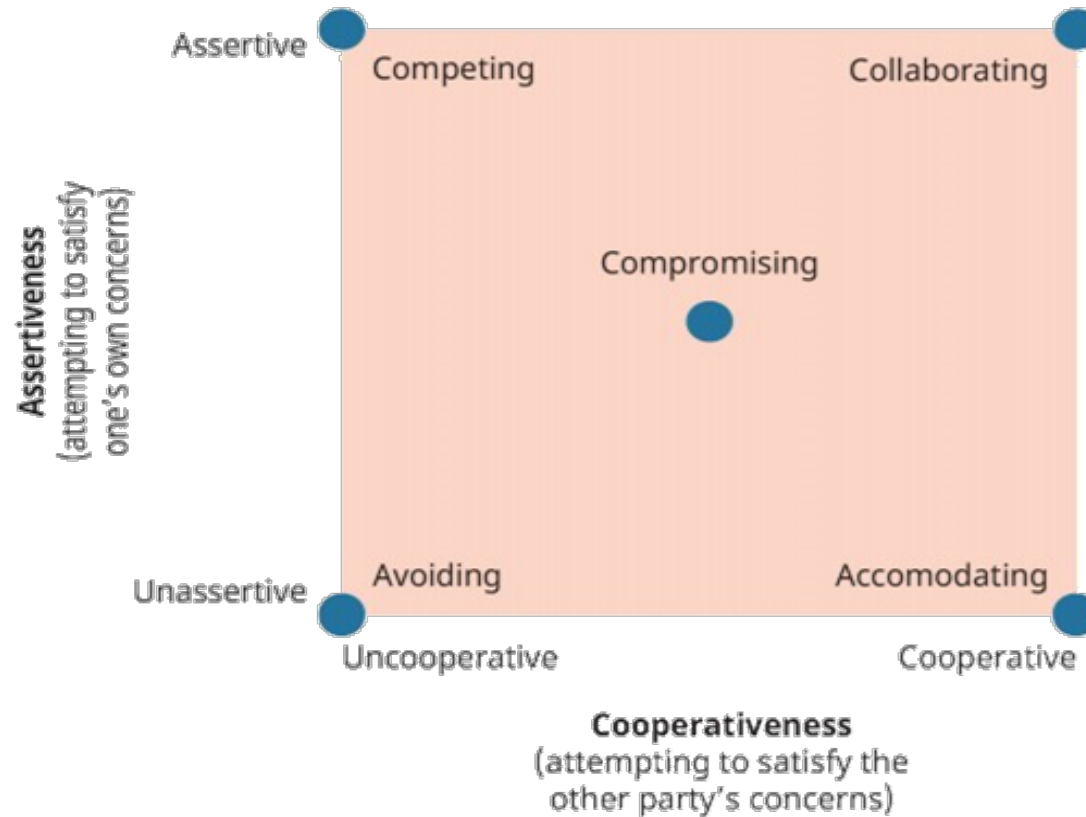


Figure 2: Approaches to Conflict Resolution. Adapted from Thomas (1976). (Credit: Rice University/OpenStax/CC BY-NC-SA 4.0)



Preventing & Reducing Conflict

04 Strategies for
Conflict Prevention

09 Strategies for
Conflict Reduction



04 Strategies for Conflict Prevention

1. Emphasizing group goals and effectiveness. Focusing on group goals and objectives should prevent goal conflict. If larger goals are emphasized, group members are more likely to see the big picture and work together to achieve corporate goals.

2. Providing stable, well-structured tasks. When work activities are clearly defined, understood, and accepted, conflict should be less likely to occur. Conflict is most likely to occur when task uncertainty is high; specifying or structuring roles and tasks minimizes ambiguity.



04 Strategies for Conflict Prevention

3. *Facilitating dialogue.* Misperception of the abilities, goals, and motivations of others often leads to conflict, so efforts to increase the dialogue among group members and to share information should help eliminate conflict.

As group members come to know more about one another, suspicions often diminish, and greater intergroup teamwork becomes possible.

4. *Avoiding win-lose situations.* If win-lose situations are avoided, less potential for conflict exists.



09 Strategies for Conflict Reduction

1. *Physical separation.* Separation is useful when conflicting individuals or groups are not working on a joint task or do not need a high degree of interaction. Though this approach does not encourage members to change their attitudes, it does provide time to seek a better accommodation.

2. *Use of rules and regulations.* Conflict can also be reduced through the increasing specification of rules, regulations, and procedures. Again, however, basic attitudes are not modified.



09 Strategies for Conflict Reduction

3. *Use of integrators.* Integrators are individuals who are assigned a boundary-spanning role between two people or groups. The integrator often takes the “shuttle diplomacy” approach, moving from one person or group to another, identifying areas of agreement, and attempting to find areas of future cooperation.

4. *Limiting intergroup interaction.* Another approach to reducing conflict is to limit intergroup interaction to issues involving common goals. Where groups agree on a goal, cooperation becomes easier.



09 Strategies for Conflict Reduction

5. Confrontation and negotiation.

In this approach, competing parties are brought together face-to-face to discuss their basic areas of disagreement. The hope is that through open discussion and negotiation, means can be found to work out problems. Contract negotiations between union and management represent one such example. If a “win-win” solution can be identified through these negotiations, the chances of an acceptable resolution of the conflict increase.



09 Strategies for Conflict Reduction

6. Third-party consultation.

In some cases, it is helpful to bring in outside consultants for third-party consultation who understand human behavior and can facilitate a resolution. A third-party consultant not only serves as a go-between but can speak more directly to the issues, because she is not a member of the group.

7. Identification of interdependent tasks and superordinate goals. A further strategy is to establish goals that require groups to work together to achieve overall success.



09 Strategies for Conflict Reduction

8. Rotation of members. By rotating from one group to another, individuals come to understand the frames of reference, values, and attitudes of other members; communication is thus increased.

When those rotated are accepted by the receiving groups, change in attitudes as well as behavior becomes possible. This is clearly a long-term technique, as it takes time to develop good interpersonal relations and understanding among group members.



09 Strategies for Conflict Reduction

9. Use of training. The final technique on the continuum is training. Outside training experts are retained on a long-term basis to help groups develop relatively permanent mechanisms for working together.

Structured workshops and training programs can help forge more favorable intergroup attitudes and, as a result, more constructive group behavior.





Review & Reflection Questions

- Is conflict in groups good or bad? Why?
- Identify the types of conflict and provide examples of each.
- What modes of conflict resolution do you find yourself using when faced with a conflict in a group?
- What modes have you observed at work in your current group?
- What strategies could you use to prevent or reduce conflict in your group?



Session III.
Group & Team Theory (cont.)

Handling Stress in Groups



LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of this section, you will be able to:

- Identify sources of stress, particularly for college students
- Describe the symptoms and effects of chronic stress
- List healthy ways of managing stress that fit your current lifestyle

Being in control of your life and having realistic expectations about your day-to-day challenges are the keys to stress management, which is perhaps the most important ingredient to living a happy, healthy and rewarding life.

—Marilu Henner, actress

Causes of Stress

- As a student, you're probably plenty familiar with the experience of stress—a condition characterized by symptoms of physical or emotional tension.
- What you may not know is that it's a natural response of the mind and body to a situation in which a person feels threatened or anxious.

Causes of Stress (cont.)

- Strong emotions like fear, sadness, or other symptoms of depression are normal, as long as they are temporary and don't interfere with daily activities.
- If these emotions last too long or cause other problems, it's a different story:

Stress make you feel overwhelmed and out of control.

Negative stress

- Stress can hit you when you least expect it—before a test, after losing a job, or during conflict in a relationship.
- While everyone experiences stress at times, a prolonged bout of it can affect your health and ability to cope with life.

Positive Stress

- Stress can be positive
- For instance, it can help you develop skills needed to manage potentially challenging or threatening situations in life.
- For example: preparing for a holiday trip

Signs and Effects of Stress

common symptoms of stress:

-
- Disbelief and shock
 - Tension and irritability
 - Fear and anxiety about the future
 - Difficulty making decisions
 - Being numb to one's feelings
 - Loss of interest in normal activities
 - Loss of appetite (or increased appetite)
 - Nightmares and recurring thoughts about the event
 - Anger
 - Increased use of alcohol and drugs
 - Sadness and other symptoms of depression
 - Feeling powerless
 - Crying
 - Sleep problems
 - Headaches, back pains, and stomach problems
 - Trouble concentrating

Chronic Stress

Can impair your immune system and disrupt almost all of your body's processes, leading to increased risk of numerous health problems

Including the following:

- Anxiety
- Depression
- Digestive problems
- Heart disease
- Sleep problems
- Weight gain
- Memory and concentration impairment

That's why it's so important to learn healthy ways of coping with the stressors in your life.



Ways of Managing Stress

The best strategy
for managing stress
is by taking care of yourself
in the following ways:

- **Avoid drugs and alcohol**
- **Manage your time**
- **Connect socially**
- **Slow down and cut out distractions for a while.**
- **Take care of your health**
- **Find support**

Avoid drugs and alcohol

- They may seem to be a temporary fix to feel better
- But in the long run they can create more problems and add to your stress - instead of taking it away.



Manage Your Time

- Work on prioritizing and scheduling your commitments.
- This will help you feel in better control of your life, which, in turn, will mean less stress.



Connect socially

- When you feel stressed, it's easy to isolate yourself.
- Try to resist this impulse and stay connected.
- Make time to enjoy being with classmates, friends, and family; try to schedule study breaks that you can take with other people.



Slow down and cut out distractions for a while

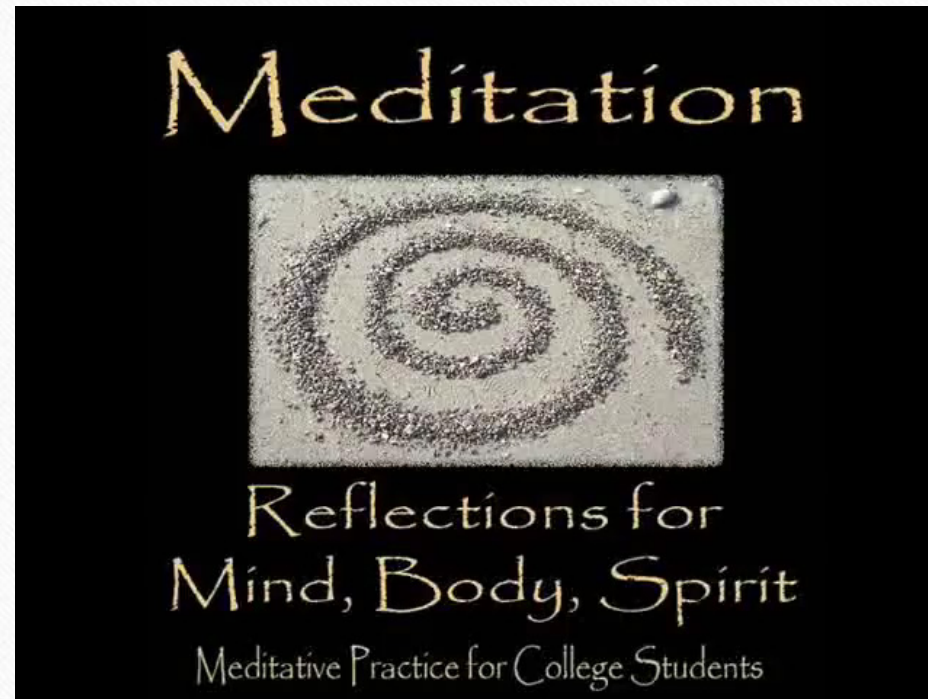
Take a break from your phone, email, and social media.



Take care of your health

- Eat a healthy, well-balanced diet
- Exercise regularly
- Get plenty of sleep
- Try a relaxation technique, such as meditation or yoga, or treat yourself to a massage
- Maintain a normal routine

Meditation



Find support

- Seek help from a friend, family member, partner, counselor, doctor, or clergy person.
- Having a sympathetic listening ear and talking about your problems and stress really can lighten the burden.
- Counseling/therapy Center
- Hospital
- Online counseling
- Hotline
- Family, Friends, ...

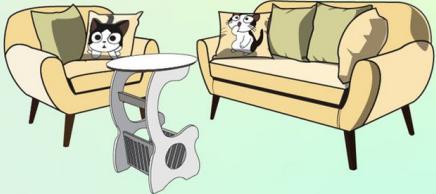
For example: Free Counseling service from your university



Phòng Tư vấn Tâm lý Cốc Kê

📍 Phòng 310R, tòa Alpha, Đại học FPT
☎ 097.545.7615
✉ tuvansinhvien@fpt.edu.vn
f facebook.com/tuivantamlyFPT

You share - we care





If the self-care techniques listed above aren't enough and stress is seriously interfering with your studies or life, don't be afraid to get help. The student health center and college counselors are both good resources.

Activity: Relaxation



